EPISODE 1

INT. LABORATORY AIRLOCK - NIGHT

Fiona Bennett stands alone, clutching a battered specimen case. A red strobe pulses above the sealed inner door.

Troy Navarro steps in, rifle slung, scanning her up and down.

TROY NAVARRO
You were supposed to radio before returning from grid six.

FIONA BENNETT
I did. Twice. No response.

He taps the comm on his vest without looking at her.

TROY NAVARRO
Protocol exists for a reason. Some people learn that faster than others.

She pushes past him into the decon chamber. He blocks her path with one arm, too close for comfort.

FIONA BENNETT
Move. The samples are time-sensitive unless you want another containment breach on your hands

TROY NAVARRO
(quiet)
Don't presume what I want, Dr. Bennett.

The airlock hisses open behind them as he lets her passjust enough space to brush against his chest.

INT. SPECIMEN LAB - NIGHT

2

Humming fluorescent lights reveal Derek Takahashi hunched over petri dishes of iridescent mosses, headphones dangling off one ear.

He looks up as Fiona enters, cheeks flushed from earlier tension.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
You made it back! Are those saplings from zone four?

She nods and sets down the case with shaking hands; he notices but says nothing right away.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(softly)
Rough night?

FIONA BENNETT
If security would focus less on my protocol adherence and more on perimeter breaches

He gently removes a shattered vial from the kit before she can touch it and cut herself againa practiced move they've done before without speaking about it aloud.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
Let's do this together? Fresh eyes help chase off nightmaresand critics.

INT. SECURITY CONTROL ROOM - LATER NIGHT

Multiple screens flicker between grainy forest feeds and biometric readouts flashing anomalous signatures near fence line delta-sixteen.

Irina Petrov sits at monitors while Troy paces restlessly nearby; Fiona argues with him by phone onscreen overlayed text:

"EXTERNAL CALL DR . F . BENNETT."

FIONA BENNETT (V. O.)
Your override locked us out of field access tonighthalf our sensors glitched because no one could recalibrate!

His jaw tightens; Irina shoots him an uncertain look as alarms softly beep in sequencesomething large moves just beyond

camera range outside.

EXT. OBSERVATION DECK - NIGHT

Wind howls through gaps where floodlights partially illuminate tree trunks swaying like vast shadows below .

Derek joins Fiona at railing , sliding over thermal goggles .

DEREK TAKAHASHI
There movement near grid seven . You see that ?

They exchange uneasy glances ; only inches apart now under humming light .

Suddenly static erupts in both their earpieces Troy's voice , urgent :

TROY NAVARRO (V. O.)
Bennett ! Something breached section D ! Get back inside now !

She stiffens , gaze locked between Derek's hand resting briefly atop hers and the monstrous silhouette slithering past

infrared beams below .

FADE OUT

.

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END EPISODE 1

EPISODE 2

EXT. OBSERVATION DECK - NIGHT

Floodlights flicker. Fiona jerks her hand away from Derek's as static crackles in her ear.

FIONA BENNETT
(to mic, urgent)
Copyheading in!

She turns for the hatch. Derek grabs her arm gently.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
Waityou dropped this.

He presses a data tablet into her palm, fingers lingering just a second too long.

Their eyes meettense, uncertainthen she pulls free and bolts inside.

INT. LAB SECURITY FOYER - NIGHT

The door clangs behind Fiona; Troy stands by Irina at a security console, face set like stone.

TROY NAVARRO
What part of "inside" was unclear?

Fiona peels off her earpiece, breath quick and defiant.

FIONA BENNETT
You keep locking us out with your blanket protocols! We're blind out thereI had to recalibrate grid seven's sensors myself!

Irina winces between them but stays silent.

INT. HALLWAY OUTSIDE CONTROL ROOM - NIGHT

Derek hurries after Fiona as she strides away from Troy's glare down sterile corridors filled with red emergency light.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(softly)
Don't let him get to you. You did the right thing coming back fastbut those readings lookedbad.

She pauses near a supply closet, rubbing tired eyes.

FIONA BENNETT
There's something different tonightthe pack isn't circling anymore.

She lowers her voice so only he can hear:

FIONA BENNETT (CONT'D)
If we don't map their patterns soon, someone else will vanish.

INT. CONTROL ROOM LATER THAT NIGHT

Screens display patchy thermal feeds; muted radio chatter hums beneath an air of tension as night deepens outside glass

walls lined with condensation and claw-marks etched faintly on metal frames.

Troy enters briskly holding printed reports, stopping beside Fiona who pores over code blinking across monitors alone

nowher expression tight but determined.

He drops the folder at her elbow without meeting her gaze.

TROY NAVARRO

New anomaly at fence delta-sixteenlab expects answers before sunrise.

Beatthey're close enough that his sleeve brushes hers when he leans in slightly lower than necessary to see the screen.

TROY NAVARRO (LOWER)
And next time? Don't risk protocol for curiosityor for Takahashi.

His voice is low: warning or jealousyit blurs together under fluorescent light.

Without looking up:

FIONA BENNETT
Understoodsir.

EXT. ROOFTOP PLATFORM PRE-DAWN

Wind bites against Fiona as she stands alone surveying treetops veiled in mista new sensor module cradled awkwardly in

arms too numb for sleep.

Footsteps approach behind; Derek appears with two mugs steaming warm condensation into cold air between them

He offers one; smiles gently despite exhaustion writ clear on his face.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

We can map their movement grids together before shift changeif you want backup this time?

Her fingers brush his when taking the mugheat lingers longer than necessarybut across campus lights flicker again:

another breach alert pulsing urgent red through fogbound windows below

7

FADE OUT

.

END EPISODE 2

EPISODE 3

EXT. RESEARCH LAB - FOREST EDGE - NIGHT

Fiona stands at the perimeter fence, flashlight in hand. The forest beyond rustles ominously.

Suddenly, a low growl echoes nearby. Fiona freezes.

TROY (O. S.)
You shouldn't be out here alone.

Troy steps into the light, his expression stern but concerned.

FIONA
I'm checking for breaches. Heard something near sector seven.

TROY
Dangerous to wander off protocol after dark. You know that.

FIONA
And you're guarding the lab 24/7? I need to do my job too.

They lock eyes tense with unspoken frustration as a shadow moves swiftly behind them in the trees.

CUT TO

:

INT. LABORATORY - MAIN ROOM - LATER

Derek arranges plant samples under bright lamps, humming softly. Fiona enters briskly, wiping sweat from her brow.

FIONA
Derek, did you see anything unusual outside?

DEREK
Just some disturbed soil and broken branches near the greenhouse entrancelike something big passed through recently.

FIONA
That's what I thought... Could it be one of those creatures?

DEREK (NODDING)
Possibly. The spores we found might have mutated local floraand faunamore than we expected.

The lights flicker suddenly; alarms start blaring faintly in the distance outside their door.

CUT TO
:

INT. SECURITY CONTROL ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Troy watches multiple monitors showing static and blurred images of movement around the lab grounds; one screen shows a large silhouette lurking near storage units.

He grabs his radio urgently and presses transmit:

TROY
All units report! Possible breach on west perimeter! Secure all exits!
CUT TO
:

EXT. STORAGE UNITS - NIGHT

9

Fiona approaches cautiously with Troy close behind her, both armed with flashlights and stun guns ready. Derek trails nervously but determined to help if needed.

Suddenly a monstrous creature bursts from shadowsa grotesque fusion of twisted vines and animal limbs snarling fiercely.

FIONA (SHOUTING)
Back up! Stay focused!

She fires her stun gun; sparks fly but only momentarily slows it down.

TROY (GRITTING TEETH)
Cover me!

He lunges forward grabbing a heavy metal pipe nearby while Derek throws an experimental chemical vial aiming for its face.

The creature recoils screaming as acid burns its skinit retreats howling back toward forest depths leaving debris scattered across ground.

Breathing heavily they regroup by storage doors.

DEREK
We can't keep fighting like this without knowing what triggers them or how many more there are...

FIONA (FIRM)
Then tomorrow we map every sign of activity inside that forest until we find answers no matter what it takes.

She looks at Troy who nods silently now less hostile than before united by survival necessity yet still tangled

between duty and trust.

FADE OUT

:

END EPISODE 3

EPISODE 4

INT. STORAGE UNITS - NIGHT

The silence after the attack is thick. Fiona wipes blood from her knucklesher own, scraped against rough concrete in the

chaos.

Troy glances at her hand but stays silent, gaze flicking between her and Derek.

Derek kneels beside a patch of scorched earth where the creature's acid sizzled moments ago.

DEREK

You alright?

Fiona flinches as she flexes her fingers.

FIONA

Just a scratch. We need samples before dawn burns all trace evidence away.

She tries to brush past Troy toward the melt marks, but he blocks her gently with one arm.

TROY NAVARRO

Don't be reckless. Wait for backup protocols

FIONA (ICY)

11

We don't have time for your procedures if we want any chance at real answers tonight.

Their standoff holds; Derek shifts nervously between them until Fiona steps around Troy, refusing to yield.

EXT. FOREST ENTRANCE PATH - NIGHT

Leaves crunch underfoot as they cross into forest shadows beyond security lights' edge.

Derek uses his UV torch on tree trunks; a faint green secretion streaks up one twisted limb.

DEREK

Look at this it's fresh. Same residue as beforebut thicker than last week's readings...

He casts an uncertain glance at Fiona then back down to his notepad app, typing quickly despite trembling hands.

INT. MONITORING STATION - LATER THAT NIGHT

Cramped inside the flickering-lit outpost: wall screens show grainy thermal views of trees and moving heat signatures just

beyond range.

Camila Kane leans over shoulder-to-shoulder with Fiona, scrutinizing data feeds while Troy stands

rigid behind them arms crossed tight across chesta silent guard more than collaborator now.

CAMILA KANE (QUIETLY)

12

Movement patterns changed again after you scared that thing off... See? They're circling closer by thirty meters each night shift

Fiona bites her lip studying timestamps; Troy looms close enough she feels his breath on neckintimidatingly near yet

never touching.

EXT. FOREST PERIMETER FENCE - DAWN APPROACHES

Sky pales as team prepares to head back in tense silence.

Troy angles himself protectively when another howl echoes far offtheir nerves raw after hours outside safety lines.

As they regroup by fence line:

TROY NAVARRO (SOFTENING EVER SO SLIGHTLY)
Next time warn me before risking our only field scientist.

Fiona keeps eyes forward but voice cracks slightlyequal parts defiant and exhausted.

FIONA
I'm not asking permission anymore not if it means letting someone else vanish next time.

Suddenly Derek pipes up quietly:

DEREK TAKAHASHI
If what we found spreads this close every nightthe containment plans aren't enough anymore

He looks directly at Fionafearful but trustingthe whole group turning instinctively toward her decision.

13

She hesitates under their expectation then squares shoulders:

FIONA BENNETT
Tonight was recontomorrow we go deeper together.
CUT TO
BLACK
END EPISODE 4

EPISODE 5

EXT. FOREST PERIMETER - DAWN

Cold mist drifts between the trees as Fiona Bennett finishes double-checking her field kit, hands trembling. The others

watch in uneasy silence.

Derek Takahashi gently places a thermos by her side.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
You forgot your tea again.

Fiona's face flushesa small, silent humiliation at being so rattled while all eyes are on her.

FIONA BENNETT
Didn't have time. Not exactly on my mind right now.

She glances upcatches Troy Navarro watching, arms crossed, gaze unreadable but fixed on her every move.

TROY NAVARRO
If you're not sharp out there, we turn around. No heroics.

Fiona straightens, forcing composure despite the sting in his tone and Derek's worried glance.

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FIONA BENNETT
Understood. But this timeI lead point.

EXT. DENSE FOREST PATH - MORNING

They advance quietly Fiona steps ahead for once as Troy and Derek flank behind with equipment bags slung tight to their

shoulders. Every birdcall feels amplified in the hush after last night's terror.

Branches snap underfoot; they halt as a patch of thick moss quivers unnaturally nearby.

DEREK TAKAHASHI (WHISPERS)
That's new It wasn't here yesterday

He kneels beside it, examining strange bioluminescent filaments weaving through the greenerydangerously close to Fiona's

boot.

INT. TEMPORARY FIELD OUTPOST - MIDDAY

Makeshift tarps flutter overhead where Camila Kane cross-references samples with satellite printouts at a folding table

cluttered with notesthe trio returns from their sweep carrying fresh specimens and tension like armor plates between them.

Camila looks up sharply when she sees blood spatter on Fiona's sleevenot hers but proof of another brush too close for

comfort out there today.

CAMILA KANE
You promised updates every fifteen minutes! The radio was dead half an hour What happened?

Troy cuts over before Fiona can answer:

15

TROY NAVARRO
Protocol held.
We encountered somethingbut containment isn't breached.
Not yet.

Camila bristles but nods warily; she glances from Troy to Fiona and backa silent question hanging about who is truly leading this operation now.

FIONA BENNETT
Collect what you need quickly.
If these readings match last night, we escalateto full lockdown procedures.

As Camila hustles away muttering into her comms unit,
Derek lightly touches Fiona's arm:

DEREK TAKAHASHI (QUIETLY)
Are you okay? You're shaking.

She pulls away reflexivelyembarrassed at showing weakness in front of both men.

FIONA BENNETT
It'll pass.

EXT. FIELD OUTPOST TENT ENTRANCE LATE AFTERNOON

Wind kicks dust across shadowy patches outside camp boundaries as Troy lingers near the entrance,
watching lab staff bustle nervously inside.

He waits until only he and Fiona remain beneath flapping canvas.

TROY NAVARRO
(controlling)
Tomorrowwe do nothing unless I say so.
Understood?

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For one moment it almost sounds protectivebut then he steps closer, blocking escape with his presence alone.

Their faces inches apart;
the air charged.

But instead of confrontation or comfort,

he quietly presses something cold into her palma small broken radio component she dropped earlier without noticing.

His hand lingers barely too long before pulling away.

She swallows hard;
equal parts gratitudeand anger.

CUT TO

BLACK
END EPISODE 5

EPISODE 6

EXT. CAMP ENTRANCE - LATE AFTERNOON

Troy steps back, his expression hardening as the breeze stirs the tent flaps.

He watches Fiona slip inside, then turns sharply and strides away without looking back.

INT. TENT - FIONA'S WORKSPACE CONTINUOUS

Fiona stands frozen, eyes fixed on the spot where Troy disappeared.

The broken radio component feels cold in her palmher fingers tightening around it instinctively.

She exhales slowly, voice barely a whisper to herself.

17

FIONA (V. O.)
I've never been this close to him... And yet we're still worlds apart.
Her gaze shifts toward the tent entrance. She clenches her jawdetermined but conflictedand finally turns away from the door, retreating deeper into her work zone as twilight descends outside.
CUT TO
BLACK

END EPISODE 6

EPISODE 7

INT. UNDERGROUND RESEARCH TUNNEL NIGHT

Fiona descends a narrow metal ladder, boots echoing on the grating. The tunnel air is damp and cold.

She flicks her flashlight on, jaw set. At her neck, the broken radio part dangles from its cordan improvised talisman.

Suddenly, Derek's voice echoes down the shaft above.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(softly)
You're not supposed to be down here alone.

Fiona glances up but doesn't stop moving forward.

FIONA BENNETT
If you're going to lecture me, wait until I find what I need.

Derek lands lightly beside her, breathless but gentle in his presence.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
That's not why I followed.

18

(beat)
We're all worried about you. About Troy tooeven if no one says it out loud anymore.

Fiona hesitates at an intersection of tunnelswalls lined with corroded pipes and mossy residue where water seeps through stone. She runs gloved fingers along faded stencils: "SPECIMEN STORAGE 2B."

FIONA BENNETT
He left me hanging again tonight.
(sharply)
And now we have less than seventy-two hours before another full perimeter sweepand no reliable comms system thanks to this mess.
She holds up the snapped radio part with a bitter laugh that cracks mid-breath.

Derek moves closer but keeps his distance respectfula silent offer for comfort or space as she needs it.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
Let me help.
It comes out softer than he means; vulnerability threads through each word.
There's more going on between you two than protocols or chain of command will fixyou know that right?

For a moment Fiona lets herself lean into the uncertaintythe darkness cocooning their confessioninstead of deflecting it away with science or sarcasm.

INT. UNDERGROUND ARCHIVE CHAMBER LATER

Row after row of rusted cabinets loom ahead under weak emergency lightsdust motes swirling in Fiona's path as she

19

unlocks an old filing drawer marked "FOREST INCIDENTS: PRE-CONSTRUCTION."

As she shuffles fragile folders aside:

A heavy footstep thuds behind themboot soles scraping concrete sharply enough to jolt both heads around fast

Troy Navarro emerges from shadow near the doorframe: jaw clenched tight, hands rigid by his sidesa soldier guarding secrets against ghosts and colleagues alike.

He locks eyes with Fiona first; then notes how close Derek stands beside her in this forbidden zone.

TROY NAVARRO
Did either of you get clearance for this?
His voice is icebut beneath it something trembles dangerously close to anger or betrayal.

FIONA BENNETT
No clearance needed when security blocks every route that might actually give us answers.

She steps toward himnot backing off even as his shadow towers over hers in lamplight.

TROY NAVARRO
That isn't your call anymore.
You keep undermining my authoritywe both know where that leads around here.

The room crackles with tensionthe kind only shared history can charge fully alive.

Derek shifts uneasily; loyalty torn clear across his features.

EXT. REMOTE MOUNTAIN RIDGE NIGHT

Wind whips across jagged stone outcrops high above treeline as Fiona stands silhouetted against moonlit forest canopy

belowa battered file clutched tightly under one arm, hair tangled by gusts stolen straight from storm clouds.

Beside her Derek shrugs deeper into his jacket Icy air warring with adrenaline still thrumming beneath skin.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
Is it true? What these files say about those disappearances... the pack formations?

He studies Fiona intentlyas if afraid hope itself hangs on whatever answer she gives next.

FIONA BENNETT

Everything points back hereto something older than us hiding in those trees. Older and smarter.

From far below: an unearthly keening rises through pinesa low rumble multiplying into layered voices neit her human nor animal.

On cue: Troy's silhouette appears at ridgecrest behind themexpression unreadable except for exhaustion dragging

hard at every line.

ALL THREE FREEZE
as distant creature calls echo like prophecy across blackened timber
CUT TO
BLACK

21

END EPISODE 7

EPISODE 8

EXT. REMOTE MOUNTAIN RIDGE NIGHT

The wind slices through the air as moonlight bleeds over the jagged rocks. Fiona stands, eyes fixed on the dark forest below, her hands clutching a worn file to her chest.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(softly)
Are you sure about those files? The disappearances... and the pack formations?

Fiona's gaze sharpens.

FIONA BENNETT
Everything comes back hereto something ancient in those woods. Older than us... smarter.

Suddenly, a low, unearthly howl ripples through the treesa sound that doesn't belong to any known creature. It rises and falls in strange patterns, echoing off distant hills like some twisted lullaby.

On cue: Troy steps onto the ridge behind themhis silhouette rigid against moonlight, exhaustion etched into every line of his face.

All three freezethe eerie calls weaving around them like ghosts in the night. Their breath catches at oncethey turn simultaneously toward a sudden rustle from above.

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A figure emerges from shadowed treetopsa girl no older than ten or eleven with wild hair tangled in leaves and twigs. Her

clothes are shredded; skin smeared with dirt streaked redher bare feet bruised purple from running on broken branches for

miles without rest or shelter...

She stumbles forward unevenly before collapsing into Fiona's arms without warningthe girl lets out a soft soband

begins shaking violently under Fiona's steady grip before suddenly going completely still all at once...

FIONA FREEZES TOO LONG

THEN INSTINCT SNAPS AWAKE

With trembling urgency she pulls away slightly to check for pulsebut finds none

Her heart drops coldshe shakes harder

NO RESPONSE

She presses both palms firmly against girl's chest again and again until knuckles ache still nothing

THEN FINALLYAT LAST

One faint tremor shivers through limp body

FIONA BENNETT (CONT'D)
(almost disbelief)

YOU'RE ALIVE

Without hesitationfury ignites beneath grief

She pulls tightly upward,

23

lifting everything left of child straight into furious embrace

And then,

without pause,

screams loud enough to tear open sky:

"HOW COULD YOU DO THAT TO A CHILD?!"

The night explodes with sound as raw human rage breaks loose across cold stone!

WIDE SHOT THE FOREST TREES SHIVER IN RESPONSE THEIR SILHOUETTES TWIST AND SHRIEK UNDER MOONLIGHT BEFORE VANISHING

INTO DARKNESS WITHOUT SOUND OR TRACE AT ALL ONCE MORE

END EPISODE 8

EPISODE 9

INT. LABORATORY - INFIRMARY NIGHT

Fiona's scream fades, but her trembling hands don't stop pressing the girl's chest.

Silence settles. The stillness feels endless.

Suddenlymovement.

The girl stirs weakly, a faint tremor running through her body like an aftershock of life returning.

FIONA (CONT'D)

(VOICE BREAKING)

You're alive...

24

Her tears spill over as she grabs the child tightly again, sobbing uncontrollably while holding what little

is left of her daughter in a broken embrace.

THEN

IN ONE BREATHLESS INSTANT

She screams againraw and shatteredwith every ounce of grief and fury:

"HOW COULD YOU DO THAT TO A CHILD?!"

The sound rips through the night aira primal human roar echoing across the cold stone!

WIDE SHOT: THE TREES SHIVER IN RESPONSE UNDER MOONLIGHT THEIR SILHOUETTES TWIST AND SHRIEK BEFORE VANISHING INTO DARKNESS

ONCE MORE

EXT. REMOTE MOUNTAIN RIDGE NIGHT9

Moonlight bleeds over jagged rocks; wind slices through thin air. Fiona stands alone on the ridge, eyes fixed on the dark

forest belowtheir silhouettes flickering in moonlight before vanishing into darkness once more She shudders violently

then suddenly collapses to her knees with a painful gaspand wails aloud:

"NO! NO!"

Her voice echoes off sharp cliffsbut no answer comes back from that cursed place anymore Her anguish fills the empty space

25

beneath fading stars until exhaustion finally claims herand silence returns to rule once more

END EPISODE 9

EPISODE 10

EXT. RUGGED MOUNTAIN RIDGE NIGHT10

Fiona lies face-down in the dirt, exhausted and broken. The wind howls through the empty forest below, carrying her cries into the night.

The moon slips behind clouds. Cold shadows creep over jagged rocks.

A lone wolf's distant howl cuts through silence.

Fiona lifts her head at the soundeyes wide with shock and disbelief.

Her trembling hand reaches out blindly to an unseen presence beside her

slowly turning toward it, voice barely a whisper:

MOTHER (V. O.)

(SOFT YET URGENT)

My child... wake up...

Fiona blinks rapidly as tears spill silently down her cheeksher gaze fixed on a shadowy figure just beyond reach of flickering campfire light.

She stumbles forward instinctivelyarms reaching for what she cannot hold

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crying out hoarsely:

"Mother? Mother!"

The figure turns sharply and vanishes without warning!

Her heart shatters again; grief surges anew

she collapses fully to her kneeswith nothing left but silent sobs against cold stone

END EPISODE 10

EPISODE 11

EXT. ABANDONED MINING TOWN PRE-DAWN

Fiona Bennett staggers through the desolate main street, bloodshot eyes scanning boarded storefronts and rusted relics.

A single lantern glows in a half-collapsed general store.

She pauses, hesitatesthen steps inside.

INT. GENERAL STORE RUINS CONTINUOUS

Dust motes swirl as Fiona creeps past empty shelves. Her breath comes ragged, but her voice is steel-edged:

FIONA BENNETT

I know you're here. I heard your radio last nightcome out!

Behind cracked crates, Derek Takahashi emerges holding a battered field notebook.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

27

You shouldn't be wandering alone. Not now.

FIONA BENNETT

(VOICE FLAT)

Is Troy with you? Did he send you to track me?

Derek shakes his head slowlyhis tone gentle but resolute.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

No one sent me anywhere. I came because you looked like hell heading up the ridge yesterday.

He takes in her trembling stance, then offers water; she ignores it, gaze hardening.

FIONA BENNETT

We need more than just us if we're going to last another week out hereor survive whatever's taken over those woods.

Her hand tightens on her satchel strap for balanceas much resolve as threat

The floorboards behind them creak suddenly

Troy Navarro's silhouette appears in the doorway: uniform dirty, jaw tense beneath hollowed eyes.

INT. GENERAL STORE RUINS MOMENTS LATER

Troy stands rigid by the entrance; silence stretches until Fiona breaks it:

FIONA BENNETT

28

Why did you run from base two nights ago? You left us blindand someone died! Talk to me!

He bristlesa muscle flickers at his jawlinebut doesn't look away from her challenge:

TROY NAVARRO

(CONTROLLING ANGER)

There were reasons beyond protocolI had orders from higher up that don't concern science staff

(OFF THEIR REACTIONS)

But I never wanted casualties on my watch. That wasn't part of any plan.

Derek looks between themfrustration simmering now:

DEREK TAKAHASHI

How do we trust any of this when every answer leads to another secret?

He moves closer beside Fionanot quite defiant, but no longer backing down either

Suddenly a metallic clang rattles outsidethe three freeze as bootsteps echo along asphalt littered with debris outside the store window.

EXT. ABANDONED MAIN STREET CONTINUOUS

Camila Kane crosses into view: lab coat half-tucked under heavy jacket, rucksack slung at her side and flashlight gripped white-knuckled in one fist.

29

She peers toward the ruined storefront where our trio hides
stops,
listens,
then calls softly into darkness:

CAMILA KANE

If someone can hear meI have information about containment... and about what's happening to people we thought were dead.

INT. GENERAL STORE RUINS DAWN LIGHT CREEPING IN

The first gold light seeps between broken planks.

Fiona pushes past Troy and Derek before they can reactsteps through shattered glass onto crumbling porch boards,

eyes blazing with new hope (or desperation):

FIONA BENNETT

(YELLING OUT)

Then stop hiding! We're done being picked off alone!

Camila steps forward warilybut does not lower her guard
as distant howls rise again across town limits,
closer this time,
unmistakable.

CUT TO

BLACK
END EPISODE 11

EPISODE 12

INT. GENERAL STORE RUINS DAWN

30

Fiona stands on the splintered porch, hands balled at her sides.

Camila inches closer, clutching a battered folderher eyes flickering between Fiona, Troy, and Derek as another distant howl fades.

CAMILA KANE
(low)
I have proof. Lab records... maps. They're hiding what's in those tunnels.

Troy steps forward fast, blocking Camila's approach with one arm.

TROY NAVARRO
You followed us here?

CAMILA KANE
No one else would listen. You want answers or not?

Derek moves to Fiona's sidehis voice calm but tense.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
Let her talk, Troy. We don't have time for posturing.

Fiona ignores them both and gestures sharply at Camila's folder.

FIONA BENNETT
Show me everything you foundnow!

Camila scans the horizon nervously before sliding past Troy to hand over the pages.

CAMILA KANE
They're experimenting under the campthe real containment zone isn't marked on any official map. I heard people screaming last night

31

Another howl erupts nearby; all four jerk toward the sound instinctively.

EXT. ABANDONED MINING TOWN MAIN STREET DAWN

The group clusters near an overturned truck as morning fog coils through shattered storefronts.

Camila lowers her voice furt her as they crouch beside rusted debris:

CAMILA KANE
Lookthe disappearances started when Dr. Wells moved equipment into that old fallout shelter beneath Sector Three...

She points shakily toward a caved-in access shaft across town square.

Derek studies the map she offers; his brow furrows with concern.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
If there really is a secondary facility underground it could explain why signals keep blacking out near Sector Three's perimeter fence

Troy grabs Derek's wrist hard enough to make him wince:

TROY NAVARRO
And how do we know this isn't another setup? Half this place runs on rumors and panic now

Fiona yanks the blueprint away from Troy's grasp with shaking fingers:

FIONA BENNETT
We check it ourselvesor we wait here until those things finish circling back to pick us off one by one.

INT. RUINED APOTHECARY MOMENTS LATER

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Sunlight slants through dust motes onto cracked tile floors littered with medicine bottles and scavenged supplies.

The group rifles urgently through packs as Fiona spreads Camila's documents across an upturned crate.

Derek kneels beside Fiona; his tone softens but urgency pulses underneath.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(quietly)
Last nightI almost ran after you in that storm. I thought you'd given up on all of us.

FIONA BENNETT
(not looking at him)
Not giving up means asking for helpeven if no one wants to give it.

He places a reassuring hand closebut not touching hers:

DEREK TAKAHASHI
You never have to face them alone againnot unless you choose it.

Behind them, Troy paces restlessly near boarded windowswatchful but visibly conflicted:

TROY NAVARRO
If we're moving undergroundwe need weaponsand someone who knows what they're walking into.
(beat)
My team used that fallout shelter years ago during fire drillsI can get us inside if you're sure about this risk
He glances briefly at Fionaa rare vulnerability in his guarded demeanor:
But once we go down therethere may be no coming back up together.

33

EXT. SECTOR THREE ACCESS SHAFT EARLY MORNING

Fog thickens as they reach twisted fencing around a half-collapsed stairwell leading below ground.

Camila lingers behindhesitantwith nervous glances back toward safer daylight streets:

CAMILA KANE
(wavering)
You really trust each other enough for this?

For onceno immediate answer from anyone.

Finally, Fiona looks first to Derekthen meets Troy Navarro's steely gaze head-on:

FIONA BENNETT

We don't have trust yetbut right nowit doesn't matter what we feel about each other outside these walls if none of us survives what's coming next.

Their shadows blur against concrete as they start down into darkness together but just before stepping out of sight, a monstrous silhouette ripples behind broken glass above, its reflection flickering over their faces unnoticed.

FADE OUT
END EPISODE 12

EPISODE 13

INT. FALLOUT SHELTER ENTRY TUNNEL EARLY MORNING

34

A heavy steel door groans as Fiona Bennett forces it open. Concrete dust swirls in the flashlight beamsshadows twitch along rust-stained walls.

CAMILA KANE hesitates at the threshold, arms wrapped tightly around a battered folder.

Fiona glances backvoice steady but raw.

FIONA BENNETT
Stay close. If you see anything moving, don't shoutsignal me first.

Derek Takahashi shoulders his pack and shoots her an encouraging look, then sweeps his light ahead down a narrow corridor littered with debris.

Troy Navarro moves past them all without hesitation, pistol drawnthe weight of command returning to his posture even here in the dark.

CAMILA KANE
(whispering)
There'ssomething wrong in this air. It smells like old chemicalsand something else

TROY NAVARRO
Keep your head up and your mouth shut unless you want every scavenger left down here finding us before we're ready for them.

He motions everyone forward through sagging archways deeper into the bunker's maze.

INT. MAIN BUNKER HALL CONTINUOUS

35

The group fans out beneath flickering emergency lights barely clinging to life on backup power.

June Castillo stands guard by a steel cabinet overflowing with medical suppliesa recent arrival judging by her wary stance

and pressed lips.

Fiona approaches, lowering her voice:

FIONA BENNETT
We need allies who know these tunnelsas many as will listen now.
(to June)
What's left of your crew?

JUNE CASTILLO
Most scattered when things got bad topsideI can get one or two on board if you tell me what we're facing for real this time.
(glancing at Troy)
No more lies or "security protocol" answersI want honesty before I risk my skin again.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(low, earnest)
She'll deliverwe all will.
(softening furt her toward Fiona)
But we have to trust each other too. Otherwise none of us make it out when those things come looking tonight.

CAMILA KANE
(tentative)
You said there was another way outa maintenance shaft behind Sector Five? My notes suggest it's still clear...

Troy scoffs quietly but doesn't argue; instead he lingers near Fiona, eyes narrowed.

36

INT. DIM SIDE CORRIDOR MOMENTS LATER

Footsteps echo as Derek falls into step beside Fiona while Camila scouts ahead with June's map tablet glowing faintly

blue-green between them all.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
That look from Navarrohe isn't telling you everything about why he came back after leaving camp last week.
(pauses; gentler now)
You deserve more than half-truthsfrom any of us.

FIONA BENNETT
(firm)
I'm done waiting for anyone else's permission or explanations. The only thing that matters is stopping whatever hunts usand keeping these people alive.

Suddenlya shudder runs through the concrete underfoot.
Somewhere beyond their circle of light: a guttural scraping sound echoes off metal pipes overhead.

JUNE CASTILLO
(urgent whisper; clutching radio)
Back routeit really is open! But someone welded new locks on from inside last nightthat means whoeveror whateveris still down here hiding.

They freeze in place as Troy steps protectively between Fiona and the darkness,
his jaw tense.

TROY NAVARRO
(grim)
Bennettyou wanted direct answers? Fine: There are things I saw during my last patrol underground,

37

things no one else survived long enough to report
and if we split up now,
you won't hear those warnings until it's too late.

Beata hint of confession cracks through his stoic mask.

Their radios crackle abruptly with static; then: muffled sobbing filters through, somewhere deep within an unlit shaft behind sector five.

CAMILA KANE
That isn't interferencethat's human

All eyes turn to Fionathe choice hanging heavy:
Pursue the new lead alone?
Or force unity despite every fracture among them?

Her breath catches;
resolve hardening beneath fear.

END EPISODE 13

EPISODE 14

INT. FALLOUT SHELTER DARK SHAFT ENTRANCE

Fiona Bennett stands at the shaft's edge, flashlight trembling. The muffled sobbing echoes againcloser now.

CAMILA KANE
(urgent whisper)
We can't leave whoever that is down here.

Fiona glances back at Troy Navarro and Derek Takahashihesitation flickers, but resolve sets in.

FIONA BENNETT

38

(low, steady)
We move as a unit. No more splintering.
Camilayou're with me on point.
Troy covers our rear. Derek, stay close
and map every turn.

Derek nods quickly, relief fighting his nerves.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
You really think it's human? Not
(swallows hard)
not one of them?

TROY NAVARRO
(grim)
If it was a creature,
we'd already be dead or running.
Stay alert.
They adapt faster than you realize.

INT. BUNKER TUNNEL CONTINUOUS

They move through crumbling concrete passages. Fiona leads briskly; Camila holds her shoulder-flashlight tight to the wall.

Suddenlya crash behind them. Everyone freezes as Troy raises his weapon instinctively.

IRINA PETROV (O. S.)
(from shadowed alcove)
Don't shoot!

Irina Petrov stumbles out into weak lightdusty, pale but alive, clutching a battered notebook to her chest.

CAMILA KANE
(stunned whisper)
Irina You're supposed to be

39

Irina scans their faces with wild eyes before locking onto Fiona desperately.

IRINA PETROV
You shouldn't be down here!
It knows we're togetheryou brought it right to us!

She collapses against Fiona; Camila catches her elbow just in time. Irina shoves the notebook into Fiona's hands with shaking fingers.

IRINA PETROV (CONT'D)
Everything they hid about Sector Sixit's all there!
But you have to get out before

The radios crackle violently.
This time not staticbut guttural hissing, something wet scraping metal somewhere deeper below them.

INT. BUNKER TUNNEL MAKESHIFT DEFENSIVE HALT

The group ducks behind overturned crates near an old generator room door.
Fiona kneels beside Irina,
flipping open the battered notebook:
diagrams of mutated limbs,
lists of names crossed out violently,
and crude maps leading toward "SUB-VECTOR CONTROL."

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(reading over her shoulder; voice low)
Those are patient logs
That symbolthat means subject transfer protocols were breached weeks ago

Troy tenses visibly;
he shoots a loaded glance at Fiona then finally speaks:

40

TROY NAVARRO
(firm but quiet)
BennettI never left because I wanted distance from this place or from you There are orders none of us were meant to survive carrying out down here. If anyone finds those logs above groundit won't just be monsters coming for us next timeit'll be commandos or worse

He stops himself short as another hiss reverberates between pipes overhead the shadows seem closer now.

INT. GENERATOR ROOM MINUTES LATER

Stripped machinery looms like skeletons beneath sputtering lights as they barricade themselves inside for a moment's respite.
Fiona pages through maps and scribbled warnings while Camila tends silently to Irina's wounds nearby;
Derek paces anxiously along cracked tiles;
Troy stands guard by the only entrance, gun raised but face conflicted.

FIONA BENNETT
(to herself; bitter edge creeping in)
Command covered up everything Used us all as bait

She looks up sharplyfirst at Derek,

FIONA BENNETT (CONT'D)
We need allies who aren't afraid of what happened hereor willing pawns for whatever this place created.

Her gaze meets Troy's across broken glass and cold aira challenge unspoken:
choose your side.

41

Suddenlythe generator hums back online unexpectedly;

Emergency floodlights snap on throughout unseen corridors outside.

Multiple footsteps echo rapidly toward their barricaded door
voices overlapping in panic:
not creaturesbut desperate survivors calling for help beyond steel walls.

ON FIONA:

Her jaw tightens;
the weight of new hopeand greater dangerpresses close.

CUT TO

BLACK.
END EPISODE 14

EPISODE 15

INT. FALLOUT SHELTER BARRICADED DOOR DAY

Floodlights flicker overhead, illuminating dust and jagged concrete.

Fiona Bennett presses her shoulder to the door, gaze darting to Troy Navarrostill braced with weapon readyand then to Derek

Takahashi crouched beside a battered toolbox.

Muffled shouts filter through: "Please! Anyone there? Let us in!"

Derek edges closer to Fiona.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
They sound terrified. We can't just

TROY NAVARRO
(interrupts, clipped)

42

Nobody moves until we're sure they aren't infected or worse.

Fiona's jaw tenses as she studies both mentheir standoff is razor-thin.

FIONA BENNETT
If we wait too long, whatever's out there will find them firstor us.

(SOTTO; TO HERSELF)
We need allies not more ghosts on our conscience.

The desperate banging resumesa woman's voice clearer now:

CAMILA KANE (O. S.)
It's Camila! Pleasewe have wounded!

Fiona spins the locking wheel slowly, eyes never leaving Troy for consentor challenge.

TROY NAVARRO
(low)
You trust her?

DEREK TAKAHASHI
She risked everything getting us that file. She deserves a chance.

After hesitation, Troy nods curtlyweapon lowered but still wary.

INT. FALLOUT SHELTER ENTRYWAY

The door screeches open an inchjust enough for Fiona to peer through with flashlight raised.

Camila Kane stands trembling beyond; Nathan Wells leans heavily against her shoulder, blood smeared at his temple.

43

Three other survivors cluster nervously behind themall pale and wild-eyed from fear or exhaustion.

CAMILA KANE
(urgently)
Close it behind usquickly!

They hurry inside.
As soon as the last survivor clears the threshold,
Troy slams the steel shut and bolts it hard.

INT. FALLOUT SHELTER MAKESHIFT COMMON AREA

Survivors huddle near crates lit by lantern glow.
Nathan groans softly while Camila kneels beside him checking his pulse.
June Castillo wipes grime from her cheeks with shaking hands; Qian Carter mutters prayers under breath in another corner.
Silence falls thick as everyone sizes each other up for threat or promise of safety.

Fiona distributes water canteens briskly, her professional tone steady despite fatigue:

FIONA BENNETT
We'll need namesand how you got here without creature exposure. Full symptom check before anyone rests.

JUNE CASTILLO
(shaky)
Two days in storage tunnels Lost Irina on day one Saw things move that shouldn't be alive

QIAN CARTER
(voice quivering)
Something follows when lights go dimit circles back every night

44

Camila grabs Fiona's wrist suddenly, urgent:

CAMILA KANE
These peoplethey're all that made it past Sector Six alive! There were more beforethe others changed after being bitten

She breaks off; eyes glistening with trauma and knowledge withheld.

INT. FALLOUT SHELTER SUPPLY CLOSET (PRIVATE)

Laterquiet hum from generators outside; boxes crowd cramped walls.
Fiona paces tightly while Derek watches from a battered stool;
across from them stands Troy: arms folded but attention sharp.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
It wasn't just luck these survivors found us nownot if those experiments started in Sector Six years ago like Camila said...

He gestures at rough notes spread between them
maps marked with odd sigils connecting lab sectors and forest perimeters.

FIONA BENNETT
(flat)
Command always knew about this contagionthat explains their silence when teams vanished... But why let any of us live?

Her voice cracks faintly but steel returns:
If we bring these people together,
maybe we get leverage...
or enough witnesses no one higher up can bury what happened here again.

45

AN ELECTRIC TENSION FORMS
the hope of alliance twisting into new uncertainty among their circle of trustor betrayal yet again stirring beneath old scars.

Suddenlythe generator hiccups;
a warning alarm blares two floors down where survivors are bedded down
unmistakable:
heavy scraping outside far vent shafts,
and then an echoa guttural howl reverberating through concrete corridors...

ON FIONA:
Face caught between courage and dread,
she flashes a look across both men:

Is this alliance truly salvationor has she only ushered new prey deeper underground?

FADE OUT

.
END EPISODE 15

EPISODE 16

INT. FALLOUT SHELTER BARRICADED DOOR DAY16 16

The alarm continues to blare, echoing through the underground chamber. Fiona's gaze darts toward the door.

FIONA
(urgent)
We have to movenow!

She grabs Camila and starts running.

CAMILA
(panicked)
What about the others?!

FIONA
(grimly)

46

There's no time! If we don't get out of here, none of us will survive!

They rush down the narrow stairwell into darkness.

VOICE (O. S.)
(snarling)

Stop them!

Heavy footsteps pound behind them as monstrous growls close in.

CAMILA
(screaming)

They're right on our tails!

Suddenlya sharp metallic clang rings out from above. The pursuing creatures stagger, snarling in confusion as a

massive steel grate crashes downward between them and their prey with a deafening roar.

SILENCE FALLS ONCE MORE

except for one sound:

faint sobbing echoing from below,

still unanswered,

still haunting,

AND STILL BECKONING
Fade out
.

END EPISODE 16

EPISODE 17

EXT. ABANDONED OBSERVATORY DUSK

47

Wind rattles broken panes as the last daylight fades. Fiona Bennett drags herself up crumbling steps, Camila Kane limping closely behind.

Both women brea the heavilyfaces smeared with grime and fear.

The distant sobbing is gone, replaced by eerie silence and creaking metal.

Fiona pauses at the observatory's rusted doors, hand trembling just above the handle.

CAMILA KANE
(voice quivering)
Did you hear it? From below It was real, right?

FIONA BENNETT
(soft but steady)
We can't go back for them yet. We regroupget our bearings first.

She pushes inside. Faded star charts flutter on battered desks beneath a shattered dome open to stormy sky.

Footsteps echo behind her: Troy Navarro enters carrying a rifle, eyes cold and scanning every shadow; Derek Takahashi follows cautiously, his gaze flicking between Fiona's face and Camila's injuries.

INT. ABANDONED OBSERVATORY MAIN HALL
CONTINUOUS

Troy motions everyone furt her in with deliberate authority.

TROY NAVARRO
Secure all exits. Move fastwe don't know what followed us out here.

48

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(reluctant)
That grate It won't hold long if they're desperate enough.

He kneels beside Camila, checking her wound gently while glancing at Fiona for approval.

DEREK TAKAHASHI (CONT'D)
You holding up?

CAMILA KANE
(nods shakily)
It hurtsI'll manage.

FIONA BENNETT
Ignore pain only if you want to get worse. Let him look at it, Camila.

She pulls out a water bottle from her packhands trembling just slightlyand offers it around without looking anyone in the eye.

Suddenlya harsh metallic rasp from overhead makes them freeze. Something heavy paces across what remains of the domed roof.

TROY NAVARRO
(low)
Don't move or speak unless I say so.

They waitthe tension nearly unbearableas dust falls onto their shoulders from above like rain.

INT. ABANDONED OBSERVATORY STAIR WELL LANDING MINUTES LATER

Darkness grows deeper inside as Derek carefully binds Camila's leg with strips torn from an old lab coat.

49

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(whispering)
You shouldn't have been out there alone

Camila gives him a faint but grateful smile.

Downstairs by half-broken monitors, Fiona studies battered blueprints of Sector Six taped to peeling walls.

Troy stands nearby but keeps distance, arms crossed tight over his chest.

FIONA BENNETT
We need a clear route through Sector Six before night fully fallsor we'll be boxed in again.

TROY NAVARRO
(scoffs)
Sector Six is compromised. What do you expect to find except more dead ends or traps?

She turns sharply toward him.

FIONA BENNETT
Maybe proof about who set those "traps." Or why we're really here.

He doesn't answer immediatelyjust watches her too intently.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(from across room)

IF SOMEONE LEFT EVIDENCE
we'd better get it before another team covers their tracks.

CAMILA KANE
Or before one of those things gets us first.

50

An uneasy quiet settles;
the threat feels closer than everbut trust hangs by threads between them all.

EXT. OBSERVATORY ROOFTOP ACCESS HATCH NIGHT

Moonlight spills through twisted girders as Fiona climbs carefully toward an exposed roof hatch,

her breath visible in chill air.

Below: Troy waits on ladder rung two steps down.

Their voices are lownot quite conspiratorial,
but wary.

FIONA BENNETT

Why did your men block that shaft last week? You knew people were trapped below.

His jaw clenches hard; he doesn't meet her eyes.

TROY NAVARRO

Orders came directto contain spread at any cost.

She rests one tired hand against rusted steel.

FIONA BENNETT

At any costeven ours?

He looks up finallythe mask almost slippingbut then returns to icy detachment.

Distantly:

51

the guttural cry of something
not-quite-human pierces the night outside,

drawing both sets of eyes outward into
gathering dark.

CUT TO

:

INT. ABANDONED OBSERVATORY SHADOWY SIDE ROOM
MOMENTS LATER

Derek crouches over scavenged radio parts
on dusty tile,
piecing together wires by flashlight beam
while muttering calculations under breath.

Camila sits nearby:
nervous hands wringing sleeve fabric
bloody near seams.

Suddenly static crackles;
a distorted signal pulses briefly

then:

GOVERNMENT VOICE (O. S., GARBLED RADIO)

Containment breach... evacuation
protocol... All survivors report...

The broadcast cuts abruptly into blank
noise.

Dereks' head snaps upmeeting Fiona's
returning gaze through cracked glass:

DEREK TAKAHASHI

Someone tried warning us off this whole
sectorthey knew we'd come here tonight.

Camila gasps softly,

while outside,

something massive brushes against loose siding,

sending shudders throughout the building.

On edge now:

CAMILA KANE

Are they coming for usor trying to keep us away from what's hidden?

Chilled,

all attention shifts back to Fiona;

even Troy waitsfor oncefor her decision instead of issuing orders himself.

Her voice steadies despite exhaustion:

FIONA BENNETT

We're not running againnot until we know exactly who locked these doors behind usand what they wanted covered up in

Sector Six.

Outside,

clawed shadows move past shredded fence lines toward broken windows

FADE OUT

END EPISODE 17

EPISODE 18

INT. ABANDONED OBSERVATORY DUSK18 18

Wind rattles broken panes as the last daylight fades.

Fiona Bennett drags herself up crumbling steps, Camila Kane limping close behind.

53

Their eyes flicker to shadows shifting outsidetoo large, too deliberate.

SUDDENLY

A massive claw slams against loose siding, sending a shudder through the building.

The glass trembles in its frame. The floor vibrates beneath their feet.

CAMILA KANE (V. O.)Are they coming for usor trying to keep us away from what's hidden?

Chilled,

all attention shifts back to Fiona;

even Troy waitsfor oncefor her decision instead of issuing orders himself.

Her voice steadies despite exhaustion:

FIONA BENNETT We're not running againnot until we know exactly who locked these doors behind usand what they wanted

covered up in Sector Six.
Outside,

clawed shadows move past shredded fence lines toward broken windows

FADE OUT

END EPISODE 18

EPISODE 19

INT. ABANDONED OBSERVATORY NIGHT19

The clawed shadows vanish into the darkness.

54

Fiona exhales sharply, eyes narrowing as she scans the shattered windows and splintered fence lines.

TROY NAVARRO
(urgently)
We need to movenow! Those things won't wait for us to figure it out.

FIONA BENNETT
(calm but firm)
I'm not leaving until I uncover who sealed this placeand what they tried to hide here.

Her gaze hardens, locking onto the cracked doorway at the observatory's core.

FIONA BENNETT (CONT'D) (V. O.)
This is where everything starts and ends. No more running from secrets long buried in Sector Six's shadow.

OUTSIDE

The wind howls through broken panes. A massive claw slams against loose siding, rattling glass and shaking floorboards

once again. Fiona turns sharply toward the sound.

CAMILA KANE
(whispering)
They're coming back...

BEFORE ANYONE CAN REACT

The main door bursts open with a deafening crash. Moonlight floods in behind twisted silhouettes of monstrous figures emerging

from the woods surrounding themancient trees swaying under unnatural weight. Their glowing eyes lock onto Fiona Bennett

55

standing resolute in front of her team inside the crumbling observatory buildingthey know exactly who they want now.

FADE OUT

END EPISODE 19

EPISODE 20

INT. ABANDONED OBSERVATORY MAIN HALL - NIGHT20

The monstrous figures halt at the threshold, their eyes flickering with predatory anticipation. Fiona's gaze sharpens as she steps forward, her posture defiant.

FIONA BENNETT
(coldly)
So you finally came for me.

Her voice is steady but carries an edge of warning.

CAMILA KANE (V. O.)
(whispering to Derek)
They're not after us... they want her.

Derek glances at Fiona, concern flashing across his face before he instinctively moves to stand beside her. Troy doesn't movehis expression unreadable but tense.

One figure lunges forward suddenlya blur of motion and razor-sharp claws aimed straight at Fiona's head. Her reflexes kick in instantly; she ducks low just as the strike slashes through empty air behind her.

56

Fiona pivots smoothly on one knee, driving a precise elbow into the attacker's jaw. A sickening crunch echoes through the

roomthe creature collapses instantly, groaning in pain and disorientation before curling into a trembling heap on the

floor.

The remaining monsters hiss and growl in unisonthen surge forward again from both sides of the broken doorway like shadows

closing in around prey.

FADE OUT

END EPISODE 20

EPISODE 21

INT. SECTOR SIX RESTRICTED ARCHIVE WING NIGHT

Fiona Bennett bursts through a heavy magnetic door, shoving it shut behind her. Her breath rasps in the sterile silence.

Emergency lights flicker overhead, casting long shadows between rows of sealed containment lockers.

Her hands tremble as she checks the coded keypadlocking herself inside.

Heavy footsteps echo distantly outside the vault.

She presses her ear to the steel wall.

TROY NAVARRO (O. S.)
(cold, muffled)
Bennett. Step away from that door right now.

She hesitates but remains silent, heart pounding.

57

A metallic boot clangs closer on concreteanother voice approaches behind Troy's:

DEREK TAKAHASHI (O. S.)
(soft but urgent)
Let me talk to her, Troy. She just fought off three... things for us out there!

The tension is palpable even through steel.

TROY NAVARRO (O. S.)
We follow protocol or we lose more people.
(to Fiona, clipped)
Open this vault before you compromise all of Sector Six.

FIONA BENNETT
(sharply)
You want these records? Come get them yourself. I'm done being your diversion while you rewrite reports in your office!

Silence from outsidea standoff measured in shallow breaths and buzzing fluorescent lights.

INT. SECTOR SIX ARCHIVE VAULT CONTINUOUS

Fiona wipes blood from her temple with a sleeve and turns toward a mainframe terminal at the end of the aisle.

Files scroll by: "Experiment Delta", "Observer Incident", "Bennett Subject Anomaly".

Her hand hovers over "Access Restricted".

58

Suddenlyher personal comm crackles alive; Camila Kane's shaking voice cuts through static:

CAMILA KANE (OVER COMM)
(whispering rapidly)
They're hunting for survivors... I saw two more dragged below Archive B! Derek tried to warn you

FIONA BENNETT
(growls under breath)
Of course he did...

She taps back into security feedsflickering images show shadowy creatures moving past glass doors

elsewhere in Sector Six.

EXT. SECTOR SIX SERVICE CORRIDOR OUTSIDE ARCHIVES SAME TIME

Derek Takahashi paces anxiously while Troy Navarro stands stone-still beside him, arms crossed tight over his vest.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(low urgency)
If we don't move fast she'll be cut off completely down here.
(troubled pause)
Let me go firstI know how she thinks when she's cornered like this...

Troy studies Derek coolly without moving an inch towards cooperation.

INT. SECTOR SIX ARCHIVE VAULT

Alone with only quiet whirring machines and distant cries for company, Fiona hesitateseyes tracing log entries

on-screen about experimental subjects linked to genetic "reformatting".

59

Sudden thump at far enda wall panel shifts slightly outward as if pressured from within.

Her fingers tighten around a nearby emergency wrench.

ARCHIVE VAULT PANEL

The panel creaks open furt hera trembling hand appears: Camila Kane pulls herself halfway out from a hidden crawlspace

beneath archival shelving, face pale and gasping for air.

FIONA BENNETT
(rushed whisper)
Camila! Keep lowthe creatures are swarming aboveground routes now.

CAMILA KANE
(struggling up; shaken but defiant)
You think hiding will save us? You can't keep shutting everyone else out every time things fall apart

FIONA BENNETT
(stung; barely contained frustration)
If I hadn't acted no one would've made it here in one piece!

CAMILA KANE
And what now? Lock yourself away again while those monsters adapt faster than any code lock?

Their argument is interrupted by another metallic crashthe archive entry is being forced open.

EXT./INT. TRANSIT TUNNEL ENTRANCE BELOW SECTOR SIX MINUTES LATER

Low alarms wail as Derek guides Fiona and Camila into darkness below ground levelthe emergency hatch grinding closed above them

after their escape from archives' rear utility shaft.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(breathless relief)
That was too close Is everyone okay?

CAMILA KANE
(snarling quietly)
Ask your friend who keeps treating us like liabilities not teammates.

Awkward silence lingers between themall eyes shift uneasily toward Fiona.

She finally speakswith new exhaustion:

FIONA BENNETT
(flatly)
No more running blind.
We find where they're keeping my familyand what I am risking my life foror none of us leaves these tunnels alive.

Behind themin pitch blackness deeper inside the tunnela faint chittering echoes closer than before.

FADE OUT
END EPISODE 21

EPISODE 22

INT. UNDERGROUND TRANSIT TUNNEL CONTINUOUS

The tunnel is pitch black except for Derek Takahashi's wavering flashlight. Fiona Bennett draws a shaky breathher jaw set

despite exhaustion.

61

Behind them, the chittering grows sharper, echo bouncing off stone.

CAMILA KANE
(low, urgent)
We shouldn't stop moving.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(strained whisper)
Stay close. There's an old maintenance hub up aheadI think we can barricade there if

FIONA BENNETT
No.
No more hiding behind doors and hoping they pass us by.
If there's something down hereit already knows we're here.

Fiona glances back at Camilaresentment flashes between them in the dark.

CAMILA KANE
(angry whisper)
Maybe if you'd listened before, your family wouldn't

She stops herself. The accusation hangs between thema wound barely concealed.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
Let's keep it together.
Fiona what do you need from us right now?

She hesitates, shivering slightly as the chittering fades into damp silence.

FIONA BENNETT
(practical)
You know these tunnels? Guide me to any secured access pointthe older systems might still have logs or bypass routes.

62

We find proof about my familyor at least where Sector Six sent themand then we plan our next move above ground. Clear?

Camila looks away but nods grudgingly.

INT. TUNNEL MAINTENANCE HUB MINUTES LATER

Rusty tool racks line concrete walls; flickering backup bulbs bathe everyone in cold light as Derek pries open a junction box for power access.

CAMILA KANE paces near the door, arms crossed tight over her chestglancing between Fiona and Derek with growing impatience.

DEREK TAKAHASHI carefully rewires circuits while keeping one eye on Fiona:

DEREK TAKAHASHI
You ever think about actually leaving all this behind?
Forest lab monsters? Sometimes I wonder if that isn't just survival instinct talking anymorebut something else pulling us deeper in every time we try to escape

He trails off when he catches the look in Fiona's eyes: unreadable but fierce beneath fatigue.

FIONA BENNETT
If I leave without answersthey win. And whoever survives after us will be bait for whatever comes out of those woods next week instead of tonight.

Suddenly Camila steps forward:

CAMILA KANE
(frustration breaking through)

63

All this convictionyou forget some of us never signed up to be heroes!
Some of us still want a way out!

Silence falls hard until she turns abruptly toward the exit hatchthe tension thickening.

EXT. FAMILY HOME COMMAND CENTER (ONCE FIONA'S CHILDHOOD HOUSE) NIGHT

Floodlights cast harsh lines across battered fencing and makeshift antennae on the porch roof. Troy Navarro stands inside

by a bank of monitorsexpression icy as he tracks signals blinking on screens marked "TRANSIT ZONE C2".

Jack Tanaka lingers nearby with an encrypted radio receiver buzzing low static beside him.

INT. FAMILY HOME COMMAND CENTER CONTINUOUS

TROY NAVARRO leans over surveillance feeds; his voice remains clipped even as concern flickers in his eyes watching

three heat signatures blink across Tunnel Map 6B:

JACK TANAKA
(reading displays)
That last archive breach tripped alarms along four sectorsincluding Main Tunnel Northbound.
Should I send recon teams?

TROY NAVARRO
(firmly)
Negative.
Standby evac onlyI'll handle sector comms myself.

64

Jack frowns but obeys; Troy taps commands into another terminal, pausing before opening a secure channel:

INTERCUT INT. TUNNEL MAINTENANCE HUB / INT. FAMILY HOME COMMAND CENTER (SPLIT FEED)

Crackling static erupts from an old wall intercom just above Fiona's headshe jumps as Troy Navarro's voice breaks through distorted audio:

TROY NAVARRO (V. O.)
Bennett
Report status now.

Beateveryone freezes at hearing his unmistakable tone echo through their hidden refuge.

FIONA BENNETT
(bracing herselfto intercom)
We made it past Sector Six archives alivewith evidence and two survivors accounted for.

Quick glance toward Camila who meets her gaze defiantly.

FIONA BENNETT
But unless you unlock transit nodes B4B7 remotelywe're stuck down here.

Silence crackles.

Then:

TROY NAVARRO (V. O.)
Understood.

His hesitation is briefbut telling:

TROY NAVARRO (V. O.)

65

Data first, Bennettthat was always our deal.

An old argument rises unspoken on both sides.

Behind Fionathe faint sound returns: not chittering now,
but slow deliberate footsteps approaching from deeper darkness down-tunnel.

END EPISODE 22

EPISODE 23

INT. SECTOR SIX RESTRICTED ARCHIVE WING NIGHT23

The slow footsteps grow louder, closer.

Fiona stiffens, voice tight.

FIONA BENNETT
(whispering)
They're coming... again.

CAMILA KANE
(scowling)
Don't tell me we have to run again!

Derek steps forward, scanning the shadows with his dim flashlight.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(firmly)
Stay close. Move silently. We can't afford another encounter like last time.

Sudden movementa figure emerges from the darkness behind them. Camila gasps and raises her arm instinctively to strikebut

it's Fiona's daughter, LUCY JAMES (10), trembling and pale in patched clothes, eyes wide with fear and disbelief.

LUCY JAMES

66

(horrified)
Mom is that really you?

Fiona freezesstaring at Lucy in shock before breaking into a soft smile as she rushes forward to embrace her tightly.

FIONA BENNETT
(teary but steady)
Lucy! You're alive

Camila stares at Lucy coldly for a moment before turning back to Fiona sharply:

CAMILA KANE
(skeptical)
You knew about this? Why didn't you say anything sooner?

Fiona holds Lucy protectively, calm but resolute:

FIONA BENNETT
(calm but firm)
Because I needed proof firstand now I do. My daughter survived this nightmare too And together we will expose everything they've done here.
The sound of heavy footsteps echoes suddenly from deeper within the tunnel. Everyone tenses instantlyturning toward the noise with wide eyes.

END EPISODE 23

EPISODE 24

INT. SECTOR SIX RESTRICTED ARCHIVE WING NIGHT24

The footsteps grow louder, closer.

Fiona's expression hardens in shock as she instinctively pulls Lucy behind her.

FIONA BENNETT

67

(urgent)
Lucy, stay close to me.

Derek steps forward protectively, scanning the approaching darkness with narrowed eyes. Camila grips a crowbar tightlyher

gaze flicking nervously between them and the shadows ahead.

CAMILA KANE
(low, tense)
Who could still be here?

Suddenlytwo monstrous figures emerge from deeper in the tunnel, their glowing eyes reflecting cold light. Their movements are

jerky and unnatural yet disturbingly humantheir heads tilt side to side as they advance slowly toward Fiona's group.

LUCY JAMES
(terrified)
Mom what are those things?

Fiona stiffens at Lucy's words but forces herself to remain composed. She turns sharply back toward Derek and Camilawith

fierce determination flashing through her eyes.

FIONA BENNETT (CONT'D)
(coldly resolute)
We don't have time for this nonsense anymore. If you're truly humanand not one of these monstersyou need to prove it now!

Before anyone can reacta low growl cuts through the air. One of the creatures lunges suddenly toward Lucy without

warning or hesitation

TIME SEEMS TO SLOW

68

Camila lets out a sharp scream and throws herself forward recklessly

CAMILA KANE
(screaming)
No!

The creature slams into Camila like an avalanchethe impact deafeningly loudand pins her under its massive frame before she can even reach Lucy...

END EPISODE 24

EPISODE 25

INT. SECTOR SIX RESTRICTED ARCHIVE WING NIGHT25

The creature's massive claws pin Camila down, its monstrous eyes fixed on Lucy.

CAMILA KANE
(struggling)
Get away from her!

Camila pushes against the creature, trying to shove it backbut it's too heavy. She stumbles and falls backward onto the cold floor.

LUCY JAMES
(terrified)
Mom!

LUCY LUNGES FORWARD INSTINCTIVELY

The creature slams into her with brutal force.

Lucy screams in agony as she collapses under the impact; blood splashes across the ground.

69

Fiona freezes for a split second before snapping back to reality, rage flaring in her eyes.

FIONA BENNETT
(yelling)
No!

BEFORE FIONA CAN MOVE

Suddenlythe door at the far end of the tunnel bursts open with a thunderous crash. A figure storms inside: DREK

TAKAHASHI (early 30s), his face sharp and determined. He charges straight towards them without hesitation, grabbing Lucy

from beneath one of the creatures' legsand lifting her clear off their grip.

Derek slams his fist into one of them so hard that its head snaps sideways with a sickening crackthen he turns swiftly and

kicks another squarely in its chest, sending it flying backward like a ragdoll across the concrete floor.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(gritting his teeth)
You monsters... get off my daughter!

One by onehe fights through every last monstrous figure blocking their pathwith ruthless precision and ferocity unmatched

by any human being here tonight...

Then suddenlya shrill scream cuts through everything:

From deeper within this darkened wing footsteps echo wildly

It's CAMILA'S VOICE,

UNMISTAKABLY TERRIFIED

70

CAMILA KANE (O. S.)
(panicked)

Dr.

Her name hangs unfinished as Fiona spins around sharply,

EYES WIDE

But no sooner does she start running toward that sound than something unseen strikes again

Another deafening CRACK rips through space behind them,

And nowit's DEREK who staggers forward first collapsing heavily against Fiona's shoulder

His body trembles violently as he gasulps for breath

HIS FACE TWISTS HORRIFICALLY

He vomits black blood all over both their shoes.

Fiona recoils instantly horror flooding every inch of her expression.
She grips Derek tightly - shaking him hard -

HER VOICE BREAKS -

FIONA BENNETT
(urgent / desperate)
What happened?! What is going on?!

Derek lifts trembling hands toward himself -- clutching weakly at his chest --

His lips quiver slightly --

71

Thenhis whole body convulses violently His arms buckle helplessly

HE COLLAPSES INTO FIONA'S ARMS WITH A FINAL SHUDDER OF DEFEAT

END EPISODE 25

EPISODE 26

EXT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX SHADOWY LOADING DOCK NIGHT

Rain drips from corroded beams above. Fiona Bennett braces Derek Takahashi's sagging weight against her shoulder, his breaths ragged.

Camila Kane rushes behind, clutching a stained med kit.

Fiona's hands are shaking as she hauls Derek to a half-collapsed crate and lowers him down.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(voice faint)
Sorry don't let go

FIONA BENNETT
You're not dying on me tonight. Breathe, Dereklook at me!

She wipes black blood from his chin with the back of her sleeve.

CAMILA KANE
We need help! This isn't just an infectionit's something else!

Fiona mouths silent calculations, gaze darting across the ruined compound for threatsor hope.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

72

(desperate whisper)
It burns in my veins like it wants out...

He seizes her wrist suddenlypanicked eyes searching hers.

DEREK TAKAHASHI (CONT'D)
Lucy said... only you can fix this...

Her jaw clenches. She pulls away gently but keeps hold of his hand.

FIONA BENNETT
You heard what Lucy told me? About my father? The experiments weren't about monstersthey were about us becoming them

Thunder rumbles overheada distant car engine whines through empty streets beyond the fence line.

INT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX MACHINE ROOM MOMENTS LATER

Dim emergency lanterns flicker over rusted machinery and scattered case files.

Fiona kneels beside Derek; Camila fumbles for supplies nearby, trembling hands moving too fast to be steady.

Footsteps echo on metal stairs

Troy Navarro emerges from shadow, gun lowered but face unreadable.
His gaze lands unsparingly on Fiona's bloody shirt and Derek's convulsions.

TROY NAVARRO
This is your big plan? Bleeding out in ruins?

73

He tosses a sealed vial onto the floor near her feeta tiny splash of dark liquid inside catching lamplight.

TROY NAVARRO (CONT'D)
That's what you wantedthe original sample. Tell me how deep your family really went into this project before I waste any more time here.

CLOSE ON:
Fiona stares at the vialhands steady now despite everything.

FIONA BENNETT
My family never stopped trying to control these mutationsthey just changed who they experimented on.
That includes people like himand like Lucy.
And maybe even you.

Silence hangs thick between them.

TROY NAVARRO
(grim)
Save your lectures for after he stops choking to death.
If there's anything left of him by then.

Camila hesitates by the doorway, torn between fear and loyalty.

CAMILA KANE
Then stop arguing! He needs real medicinenot secrets!

THE MOMENT FRACTURES
Outside: Another shape slinks past shattered windows. A low growl reverberates somewhere below ground level.

INT. MACHINE ROOM CORNER ALCOVE CONTINUOUS

74

Rain trickles down cracked glass as Fiona injects medication into Derek's armthe serum Troy provided lies untouched beside her knee.
Her voice drops almost inaudible:

FIONA BENNETT
(soft)
If this doesn't workwe try your way next.
But you trust me first...

He nods weakly,
gripping tighter as if afraid she'll vanish.

Suddenly:
Heavy pounding echoes through concrete halls outside.

EXTREME CLOSE-UP:
The untouched vial reflects distorted faces: Fiona's resolve tightening; Troy watching warily;
and far offin rain-streaked shadowsa monstrous silhouette moves closer,
yellow eyes burning hungrily in darkness,

leaving Fiona forced to choose:

Trust science or gamble with unknown power?

FADE OUT

.
END EPISODE 26

EPISODE 27

INT. MACHINE ROOM CORNER ALCOVE NIGHT

Rain pounds the metal roof above. Derek breathes raggedly, his skin clammy against Fiona's steady hands.

75

A monstrous silhouette slinks just outside the smeared glassyellow eyes fixed, unblinking.

Troy stands at the doorway, weapon drawn but gaze locked on Fiona instead of the threat beyond.

FIONA BENNETT
(urgent whisper)
The dosage should stabilize you. Just brea the with me Derek

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(struggling)
I trust you. But if it gets worseyou have to promise

He breaks off as a shudder wracks his body.

Fiona forces herself to meet Troy's impatient stare.

FIONA BENNETT
(low and forceful)
We need isolation protocol now.
If that thing breachesthe serum won't matter for any of us.

TROY NAVARRO
(clipped)
You still haven't told me what Lucy said.
What are you hiding?

The pounding outside grows louder; shadows flicker across wet concrete as claws scrape metal siding.

Fiona glances toward Derek, then back at Troyhaunted resolve in her eyes.

FIONA BENNETT
Lucy remembered where they took my mother.

76

She thinks there's something lefta fail-safe or evidence. But I'm not risking everyone unless I know we can make it out alive this time!

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(pained sincerity)
Then let me helpI'll go with you (as he coughs hard) Just not tonight

Another heavy thud shakes loose rust from overhead pipes. The creature presses its face to shattered glassa guttural growl

vibrates through steel and bone alike.

EXT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX REAR ACCESS RAMP MOMENTS LATER

Rain sheets down as Fiona braces Derek between herself and Troy, hustling him along a cracked loading ramp dusted with

debris and weeds grown wild through concrete seams.

TROY NAVARRO
(under breath to Fiona)
This is recklesswe need proof before going after ghost stories. Don't drag him into your family drama when he can barely stand.

FIONA BENNETT
(hissed reply)
You don't get to decide who risks what anymorenot after Sector Six! Either cover us or move aside.

Thunder rattles hollow silos nearby; monstrous shapes shift deep within shadowed corridors behind them.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(faint smile despite pain)
Remind me why I ever argued with you?

77

She squeezes his hand quickly before letting goher mask slipping for half a second.

Suddenly:
From atop a ruined catwalk abovethe yellow-eyed creature leaps down between them and escape,
blocking their only route out.

INT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX SERVICE BAY
CONTINUOUS

Metal screeches under massive weight as the beast stalks closermuscles bunching beneath slick black hide.

Fiona fumbles in her bag for makeshift incendiaries; Troy steps forward, gun leveled but jaw tight .

TROY NAVARRO
(intense)
If we do this your wayyou call every shot until morning .
But I want everything afterwardall data , all files about your mother .

Derek coughs violently , nearly collapsing again .

FIONA BENNETT
(fierce , torn )
Fine ! Take whatever damn secrets you want . Get us past this first !

She lights a flare in trembling hands, shoving it against oily rags thrown at the monster's feet.

Fire flashes illuminating furious yellow eyes

CLOSE ON FIONA:

78

Her voice waversbut does not break:

FIONA BENNETT

(LOUD OVER CHAOS)

Stay back! You want answers? Survive till dawn!

As flames leap higher,

the creature snarls backwardbut doesn't retreat fully,

eyes burning into hers.

CUT TO

BLACK.

END EPISODE 27

EPISODE 28

INT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX MAINTENANCE SHAFT NIGHT

Flare-light dances along warped steel walls.

Fiona Bennett stands between the monstrous creature and a sagging, blood-spattered Derek Takahashi. Her hand trembles but holds firm.

The beast prowls closer, wary of fire.

Troy Navarro emerges from the shadows, pistol drawneyes flickering between Fiona and the threat.

TROY NAVARRO

(steady, cold)

Bennett. Behind youthey're circling. We need to move now or you'll lose him anyway.

FIONA BENNETT

79

(not breaking eye contact with creature)
If we run, it chases. If we fight

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(hoarse whisper)
Let's just get out please

Fiona tears her gaze from the animal and catches Troy's urgent glare.

FIONA BENNETT
Lucy said there was another way outnorth corridor past filtration tanks! She wasn't lying; I mapped those ducts as a kid!

TROY NAVARRO
(grudgingly impressed)
You withheld that?

She lights a second flare and hurls it behind the creatureit startles back with an unearthly shriek.

Derek clutches her sleeve; his breath rattles deeper.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(struggling to stay conscious)
Something's wrong inside meit burns every time I brea the in here...

Fiona steadies him with one arm as she pushes toward the duct opening at their backsa hatch half-concealed by rusted

panels. Troy covers them, firing once into open darkness to drive creatures back momentarily.

INT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX AIR FILTRATION CHAMBER CONTINUOUS

80

They stagger into stale air thick with dust and chemical tangs.
Overhead fans thrum weakly.

Fiona sets Derek down on cracked tile, immediately checking his pulse.
His skin is flushedveins darkening beneath translucent flesh.

TROY NAVARRO
Keep moving or he dies here! How far is this "secret exit" of yours?

FIONA BENNETT
(harsh)
Two more roomsI know this place better than any of you!

She hesitates only a heartbeat before pulling something small from her pocket: Lucy's locketthe secret key revealed in last night's desperate confession.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(breathless)
What did Lucy mean ... about your father? This whole complex... it's not just researchis it?

For a moment: silence except for distant monster screeches vibrating through vents.

FIONA BENNETT
(soft but fierce)
My family wasn't funding vaccinesthey engineered containment protocols for these things decades ago. All thisall of uswe were bait if they escaped control.

Her jaw clenches as she clips open the locket: inside are micro-etched schematics.

INT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX ACCESS CORRIDOR LATER

81

They hurry past shattered screens displaying old PROJECT AEGIS security feeds.
Red warning lights flicker sporadically overhead.
Every footstep echoes dangerously.

Suddenly Derek stumbles again; Fiona steadies him against her side.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(pained smile)
Maybe... should have trusted you sooner.

He gasps as black veins crawl higher under his shirt collar.

TROY NAVARRO
(low urgency)
Whatever serum you gave him isn't holding.

He grabs Fiona's wrista rare break in formality.

TROY NAVARRO
There's an experimental clinic north of townI can get clearance if you hand over those blueprints right now.

Their faces inches apart:

FIONA BENNETT
(defiant whisper)
Not until I see proof he'll live.

An ominous growl rattles metal shelves nearby the creatures haven't given up pursuit.

CLOSE ON FIONA:

Determination hardens on her face as she pockets both locket and vial,

THE PRESSURE MOUNTING

82

torn between bargaining away her legacy or risking Derek's life for answers.
CUT TO
BLACK.
END EPISODE 28

EPISODE 29

INT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX SHADOWY CORRIDOR NIGHT

Fiona Bennett presses Derek Takahashi's arm across her shoulders, half-carrying him as they hurry away from the echoing growl. Rain seeps in through shattered glass overhead.

Troy Navarro leads, gun drawn and scanning aheadevery muscle tense.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(voice barely above a whisper)
You still have the locket?

FIONA BENNETT
(grim)
It's safe. Don't talkconserve your strength.

Another thunderous snarl reverberates through metal ducts behind them.

TROY NAVARRO
We're exposed here. Stairs to street levelnow.

He motions sharply; Fiona nods, hauling Derek up concrete steps slick with water and moss.

INT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX ROOFTOP ACCESS STAIR WELL MOMENTS LATER

83

They reach a battered door chained shut from inside. Troy rattles it, jaw clenched.

FIONA BENNETT
(over shoulder)
Lucy said there was an exit on the east sidea panel behind old compressors.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(labored breath)
Your daughter She knows things about those creaturestheir patterns

His knees buckle; Fiona braces him gently but firmly against the wall. Amber city lights flicker beyond broken windows.

FIONA BENNETT
Tell me exactly what she told you before we move again!

Derek struggles for air, voice raw:

DEREK TAKAHASHI
Not just patterns Family names mixed into pack symbols Your family's name was etched on one of them

Silence fallsa heavy realization settling between all three.

EXT. INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX LOADING YARD MINUTES LATER

Rain pours down as they slip out beneath an overhang near rusted compressorsa narrow service hatch gapes open at ground level where Lucy described.

Troy covers their exit with his weapon as Fiona helps Derek crawl through first, then ducks in herselfher hand gripping

84

both vial and locket in her pocket so tightly her knuckles whiten.

INT. DERELICT DELIVERY VAN (HIDDEN IN ALLEY ADJACENT TO MEDICAL FACILITY) NIGHT

Engine idling low outside a windowless building lined with security drones: the experimental clinic Troy promised access to looms ahead, sterile and forbidding under harsh LED floodlights.

Inside the van:

FIONA BENNETT
(hushed urgency)
This is it? Your mysterious "clinic"?

TROY NAVARRO
Only place equipped for this kind of caseand only if you follow my lead precisely when we get inside.

He holds out his palm:

TROY NAVARRO
Blueprintsor he doesn't get through that door.

She hesitates; Derek tries to sit up but winces sharply.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(strained)
Fi don't risk everything for me

She turns on him fiercely:

FIONA BENNETT
Stop! You are not expendable data.
(to Troy)
You'll get what I owe when I see proof he can be stabilizednot before.

85

Their locked gazes crackle with challengethe doctor-vigilante facing off against military precision under neon

rainlight.

EXT./INT. EXPERIMENTAL CLINIC ENTRANCE
CONTINUOUS

Security scanners sweep over them as Troy murmurs codes at armed guards and ushers Fiona and Derek quickly across threshold

sensors into antiseptic white corridors humming with life-support units.

As orderlies hover nearby:

ORDERLY (V. O., FILTERED INTERCOM)
Patient needs full decontamination scan before admittance

Alarms suddenly sound deeper within facility: snarls echo faintly through ductwork above ceiling tilesinhuman sounds

far too close for comfort.

INT. CLINIC TRIAGE BAY MOMENTS LATER

Blinding overhead lights flicker past as staff wheel Derek onto a monitoring bed while Fiona keeps pace beside him

clutching his hand; Troy flashes credentials at every checkpoint but watches her warily throughout.

TECHNICIAN
(in awe/recognition)
Is that... Dr Bennett?

Whispers ripple among techniciansit is clear something more than medicine keeps this place running smoothly after hoursand

86

whatever secret runs beneath its surface recognizes HER legacy now too.

In private triage chamber:

Derek shivers violently despite heated blankets; black veins creep furt her along his neck.

He catches Fiona's wrist weakly:

DEREK TAKAHASHI
If there's truth buried in your family's work... promise me you'll finish what they startedeven if you lose me doing it.

CLOSE ON FIONA'S FACE: torn between hope and creeping dread

Outside glass partition,
a shadowy figure waits beside Troy,
folder marked "BENNETTS" visible under their arm.

Her heart poundsto save one man she may need to betray everyone else she loves or trusts.

FADE OUT

.
END EPISODE 29

EPISODE 30

INT. CLINIC TRIAGE BAY PRIVATE CHAMBER NIGHT

Fiona Bennett stands between Derek Takahashi's bed and the glass partition, breath sharp, hand frozen over his.

The shadowy figure outside the glass raps twicedeliberate, impatient. Troy Navarro blocks their entrance; tension radiates from him.

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Derek shifts against the sheets, voice hoarse.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
You have to go. Find out what they knowabout you, about this... thing in me.

FIONA BENNETT
(urgent)
I'm not leaving you alone with strangers pumping toxic cocktails through your veins

The door hisses open as Troy pushes in, folder clutched tight.

TROY NAVARRO
Someone here wants to speak with you, Dr Bennett. Privately. Now.

He glances at Dereka flicker of concern buried beneath command.

FIONA BENNETT
(to Troy)
If anything happens while I'm gone

TROY NAVARRO
It won't. You know my record.

He holds her gaze until she looks away first.

INT. CLINIC SECURE CONSULT ROOM MOMENTS LATER

Fluorescent lights buzz overhead as Fiona enters warily; the shadowy figure waits across a metal table Irina Petrov from her childhood memories but older now and cold-eyed.

IRINA PETROV
Dr Bennett... Welcome homeor what's left of it.

88

She slides the "BENNETTS" file forward just within Fiona's reach but keeps one hand firmly on top of it.

IRINA PETROV (CONT'D)
Your family's research isn't lostnot all of itbut finishing what they started comes at a price for everyone under this roof tonight including that botanist friend of yours.

INT. CLINIC TRIAGE BAY CONTINUOUS

Derek tries to sit up despite monitors screeching protest; sweat beads on his brow as he fumbles for his IV line before

giving up exhaustedly when Troy steps closer and gently steadies him with one controlled grip.

TROY NAVARRO
Don't get clever on my watch, Takahashiyou need rest or you'll kill yourself faster than any monster could manage out there.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(tired smile)
That supposed to be comforting? Because right now nothing about this place feels safe except Fiona.

Back in consult:

INT. CLINIC SECURE CONSULT ROOM

Fiona squares her shoulders but doesn't touch Irina's folder yet.

FIONA BENNETT
What did my parents do that was so dangerous even monsters fear their name?

IRINA PETROV

89

They altered more than genomesthey changed rules we barely understand.

Irina nudges open a tab: inside are blueprints labeled "Containment: Project Chimeric Lineage."

IRINA PETROV (CONT'D)
This is why you're hunted by both creatures and commanders alike. You can walk awayor accept your inheritance.

Her gaze dares Fiona.

Suddenly alarms blare distantlythe facility erupts into commotion outside.

without warning Irina slams shut the folder.

IRINA PETROV (WHISPERS)
Choose quickly:
your bloodline,
or your friends?

Through shatterproof glass beyond them red emergency lights strobe,
casting shadows across Derek's fragile silhouette...
and landing squarely on Troy's unreadable eyes,
locked onto Fiona as if awaiting judgment.

FADE OUT

.

END EPISODE 30

EPISODE 31

INT. HIGH-SECURITY GOVERNMENT RESEARCH FACILITY COMMAND CENTER NIGHT

90

Alarms pulse red across the room's glass walls. Fiona Bennett stands between Derek Takahashi, slumped in a wheelchair, and

Troy Navarro, rigid beside the security console. Irina Petrov's folder still rests on the deska loaded secret.

FIONA BENNETT
(voice steel-edged)
No one chooses my future but me.

TROY NAVARRO
You don't have time to debate with her. Security's locking down every exit.

Irina's eyes flick between themcalculating.

IRINA PETROV
Then you'd better decide what side you're on.
The lockdown is for your protectionor your containment.

Derek coughs weakly, gripping Fiona's sleeve.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
Fionawhat did she mean?
Your family

Fiona squeezes his hand; guilt and fear flash across her face, then harden to resolve.

FIONA BENNETT
Later. We need to get somewhere safe first.
(to Troy)
Options?

Troy glances at hernot cold this time, just raw uncertainty slipping through his mask.

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TROY NAVARRO
There's a maintenance passage below Sector B,
but if Command suspects youthey'll block it fast.
Or we can try for the rooftop helipadif we have air support left at all.

Irina quietly keys in something behind her backthe monitors flicker with lines of code and zone maps updating ominously red:

SECTOR B SEALED; ROOFTOP ACCESS STANDBY
OVERRIDE INITIATED.

IRINA PETROV
Your bloodline has value everywhere except here.
They won't let any of us walk out unless I vouch for you
or unless they think you're already under their control

The tension crackles as distant pounding echoes from reinforced doors down the hall. Somewhere inside those walls:

creatures or menimpossible to tell from sound alone now that everything blurs together.

INT. HIGH-SECURITY FACILITY SERVICE CORRIDOR
MOMENTS LATER

Fiona pushes Derek along cracked floor tiles lit by sickly emergency strobes. Troy strides ahead scanning corners with a

pistol raised; Irina lingers behind them all like an unwanted shadow trailing secrets instead of footsteps.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(barely audible)
My head... keeps spinning... What are we doing? Where are we really going?

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FIONA BENNETT
Anywhere safer than Irina's reach right now.
Just trust mefor five more minutes?

He nods shakily but winces as another alarm starts shrilling overhead.

Aheada blast door looms marked "BIOWEAPON STORAGE - AUTHORIZED ONLY."

TROY NAVARRO
We cut through herewe'll cross into old surveillance access above ground level.

He swipes his badgedenied.

IRINA PETROV
(smiling thinly)
Let me handle it,
unless you'd rather trigger internal defense protocols?

She steps forward; Fiona blocks her path with one arm outstretched.

FIONA BENNETT
Try anything elseand I swear I'll drag every secret you've got into daylight before they shoot us both.

For a moment it's silent but for Derek's ragged breathing and alarms beyondthe standoff charged yet brittle as glass.

INT. BIOWEAPON STORAGE VESTIBULE CONTINUOUS

As Irina palms open the next lock under heavy scrutiny:

Derek seizes Fiona's wrist unexpectedly tighthis gaze wild, pupils blown wide by fear or fever or something stranger still.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(urgent whisper)

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You feel it too?
Somethingwrong in this placeit isn't just monsters outside anymore...

His voice chokes off;
Rouge veins pulse briefly beneath his skin,
then fadea change neit her missed nor understood fully by anyone present.

Behind them:
Heavy bootfalls echo closer;
the facility shakes minutelyas though some force far greater than human protocol strains against its outer shell.

Up ahead:
The inner door grinds open revealing stairs rising toward faint slats of night skythe helipad above beckoning like

salvation...
or ambush.

EXT. SKYSCRAPER ROOFTOP HELIPAD NIGHT

Wind howls over city lights far below.
Floodlights cast stark shadows as Fiona bursts onto the metal deck pushing Derek ahead;

TROY COVERS THEIR ESCAPE
gun tracking sudden movement near mechanical vents.

Helicopter blades whir distantlybut no craft lands yet.

Far across the pad:
Paloma Stroud appears flanked by two armed guardsall focus narrowed on Fiona alone.

PALOMA STROUD
(shouting over wind)
Dr. Bennett!
Don't take another step unless everyone wants bullets flying!

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For an instant:
Everyone freezescaught between sky dark and floodlit steel,
no clear way forward except surrender... or defiance.

END EPISODE 31

EPISODE 32

EXT. SKYSCRAPER ROOFTOP HELIPAD NIGHT

Wind rips across the metal deck.
Fiona Bennett plants herself between Derek Takahashi and Paloma Stroud's drawn pistol.

Troy Navarro keeps his weapon upeyes flicking from the guards to Fiona, jaw clenched.

PALOMA STROUD
(over wind)
This is your last warning!
Step away from the botanist, Dr. Bennett!

Derek wobbles behind Fiona, breath ragged.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(low, shaking)
Fiona don't let them

He falters. Fiona shifts her stance protectively.

FIONA BENNETT
(loud, precise)
You want leverage? You picked the wrong hostage.
Let him go and I'll talk.

Paloma takes a step forward; the guards fan out behind her.

PALOMA STROUD

95

Talk fastor only one of you leaves this roof upright tonight.

TROY NAVARRO
(cold but cracking)
Back off! This isn't what we agreed on!

The nearest guard edges closer.

TROY PIVOTS SHARPLY
gun trained on Paloma's hand instead of Derek or Fiona now.

Paloma hesitates.
Silent calculation passes over her face as she registers Troy's subtle shift in allegianceand authority splinters for just a second among her team.

FIONA BENNETT
(urgent, direct to Troy)
If you're with usprove it.
Drop their comms line. Now!

For an instant everything hangs in stillness:
helicopter blades stutter overhead;
city lights glitter far below;
Derek shivers against cold steel under night sky,
caught between collapse and panic.

INT. HIGH-SECURITY GOVERNMENT RESEARCH FACILITY SECURITY MONITORING SUITE NIGHT

Banks of screens track every move on the rooftop helipad above.
Irina Petrov stands at command,
one finger poised over an intercom switch,
her gaze flinty as she listens through concealed mics to everything unfolding outside.

IRINA PETROV
(into radio; icy calm)

96

Bring me Dr. Bennett alivebut do not harm Takahashi until I say so. Navarro is expendable if he interferes.

EXT. SKYSCRAPER ROOFTOP HELIPAD NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

From below: floodlights flare brightera brief moment where all faces are visible with nowhere left to hide.

Troy narrows his eyes at Paloma then lowers his gun slowly onto the painted deck beside hima silent declaration that

draws fresh tension from everyone present.

PALOMA STROUD
(snarling)
So that's how it is? You'd risk all our lives for whatthe truth about Sector Six?

She gestures harshly; her guard steps toward Derek

without warning:
Derek surges forwardnot running but standing straighter than he has since they reached safety,
voice trembling but suddenly lucid:

DEREK TAKAHASHI
Stop! If you hurt anyone here (the words catchsomething unearthly pulses beneath his skinhis pupils dilating rapidly)

I can make this entire building uninhabitable for days. You know exactly what my blood contains now, don't you?

Everyone freezes;

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even Paloma recoils instinctively before regaining composure.

FIONA BENNETT
(desperate; sharp to Irina via hidden mic badge)
Is this enough?
My heritage against your serum
let them go!

INT. HIGH-SECURITY RESEARCH FACILITY COMMAND CENTER

Irina Petrov watches monitors intently
her lips curl into something almost resembling admiration mixed with contempt.

IRINA PETROV
(to subordinate techs)
Prepare containment unit six no mistakes this time.

EXT. SKYSCRAPER ROOFTOP HELIPAD NIGHT

Floodlights cut out in abrupt darkness except city glow from distant windows
everyone tense and half-blind atop exposed steel sixty stories above ground level.

In silence:

Derek grips Fiona's sleeveface flushed with strange feverish energy now surging through his veins rather than weakness alone.

Across scattered shadows:
Paloma signals silentlyto retreat or attack unclear;
the air thrums thick as destiny tilts by inches around choices made under pressure.

Beside Fiona:

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Troy presses close enough that their shoulders touch lightly beneath whipping wind,

voice low so only she hears:

TROY NAVARRO

(CONCEDING, RAW)

Whatever happens nextwe're doing it your way.

Above them:

Helicopter searchlights rake back across rooftop edge,

throwing monstrous shapes against concrete walls below

as sirens begin to converge somewhere far beneath.

On Fiona's face:

Resolveand terroras all lines of loyalty fracture around family secrets finally bleeding into open conflict.

CUT TO

BLACK.
END EPISODE 32

EPISODE 33

INT. HIGH-SECURITY GOVERNMENT RESEARCH FACILITY EMERGENCY DECONTAMINATION CHAMBER NIGHT

Sterile white light flickers overhead. Heavy doors hiss closed behind them.

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FIONA BENNETT staggers inside, windblown and breathless; TROY NAVARRO supports DEREK TAKAHASHI's weight as alarms echo faintly from distant halls.

For a momentonly the hum of air filtration and their ragged breathing.

FIONA BENNETT

(VOICE TAUT)

Put him downgently, Troy.

Troy lowers Derek onto a bench. Derek shivers, sweat beading his brow, hands clenching convulsively at his sides.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

(DISTANT)

Lights are wrong Everything feels sharp

Fiona kneels beside him, checking for fever with brisk efficiency. Her eyes dart to the biometric scanner embedded in the wall: red warning blinks steadily.

TROY NAVARRO

They'll send a security sweep in under two minutes if we don't clear this checkpoint.

He glances at Fionauncertain authority colliding with worry.

FIONA BENNETT

(INTENSE)

We don't move until I know he's stable enough to walkor fight if it comes to that!

She pulls out an injector from her field kita remnant from earlier experimentsand hesitates over Derek's exposed arm.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

(SOFTLY)

You're not like them, Fiona Your family built these walls for secretsnot people. That isn't you

Fiona's hand shakes just slightly before she plunges the injector home. Derek winces but meets her gaze; there is trust

and something haunted between them.

The chamber intercom crackles unexpectedly:

IRINA PETROV (O. S.)

(STATIC-LACED)

Dr. BennettI warned you what would happen if you chose sentiment over legacy. Security teams have orders not to

differentiate between intruders or traitors now... including your friends on that rooftop.

Both Troy and Fiona freeze as Irina's words ring in the sterile aira judgment handed down from unseen corridors of power

above them all.

INT. HIGH-SECURITY FACILITY SURVEILLANCE HUB SECONDS LATER

Rows of monitors display lab corridors, rooftopsand live biometrics for each sector breach alert: three signatures

pinging red near Decontamination Chamber Fourteen-A.

PALOMA STROUD stands tense behind Irina Petrov at control desk; Paloma's finger hovers over "Lockdown Protocol."

PALOMA STROUD

(LOW URGENCY)

If they override this zone too fastthe pack could breach through Sublevel Two again while everyone scrambles up top

IRINA PETROV

(UNMOVED)

Collateral damage is inevitable when dead bloodlines refuse correction.
Activate protocol.

INT. DECONTAMINATION CHAMBER SAME MOMENT

All exits lock with metallic thudsthe hum of magnetic seals vibrating beneath their feet.

DEREK TAKAHASHI struggles upright despite weakness; veins darken along his forearm where serum entered moments ago.

His voice comes steadier now, intense:

DEREK TAKAHASHI

(TO BOTH)
She won't let us out alive unless we give her what she wants.
But she doesn't realize how much more dangerous we've become together.

TROY NAVARRO steps close to Fionashoulder nearly touching hers again voice lower than before:

TROY NAVARRO
(urgent whisper)
There are hidden relays under these panelsthey use them during biohazard drills.
Give me ten seconds' cover and I'll get one open.

Fiona looks hard into his eyes: fear battling determinationall those fractured loyalties balanced on this single risk.

Her jaw sets fiercely as sirens ramp louder outside:

FIONA BENNETT
(firm)
Ten seconds.
Then we do it my wayagain.

She turns toward approaching footsteps beyond glass,

face reflected back:
resolve burning,
betrayal bracing,
the burden of every secret pressing closer as darkness gathers outside.

END EPISODE 33

EPISODE 34

INT. HIGH-SECURITY GOVERNMENT RESEARCH FACILITY EMERGENCY DECONTAMINATION CHAMBER NIGHT34

The glass door slides open with a hiss. Fiona's eyes lock on the approaching figuresPALOMA STROUD and her armed guards,

their expressions cold.

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FIONA BENNETT (V. O.)
This is itthe end of the line.

She turns sharply to face TROY NAVARRO.

FIONA BENNETT
(urgent)
Open the relay now!

Without hesitation, Troy drops to his knees beside the control panel embedded in the wall. His fingers move quickly over

hidden switches beneath loose panels as sirens wail louder outside.

CLOSE-UP: A dim red light pulses from a small circuit box inside then suddenly goes dark.

TROY NAVARRO
(focused, breath held)
Relay's down... now!

He snaps his head up toward Fiona, voice low but sharp.

TROY NAVARRO (CONT'D)
Run! I'll stall them!

Before she can respond, he pivots and bolts toward the opposite corridorfast and silent like a shadow slipping through

moonlight. Fiona stares after him for a beatthen whirls back toward DEREK TAKAHASHI lying on the floor behind her

wheelchair, fear sharpening every movement as she pushes him hard against Paloma's advancing force:

FIONA BENNETT
(shouting)

Move! Now!

Paloma freezes at the threshold of decon chamber her gaze snapping between Derek and Lucy clinging to Fiona's side

calculating fast before stepping fully inside with measured authority:

PALOMA STROUD

(SMILING THINLY)

Well well looks like you finally gave yourself away

Derek coughs weakly; Lucy grips tightly onto Fiona's hand as they brace themselves for what's coming next.

END EPISODE 34

EPISODE 35

INT. HIGH-SECURITY GOVERNMENT RESEARCH FACILITY DECONTAMINATION CHAMBER NIGHT

Lucy clings to Fiona Bennett's side, eyes wide. Paloma Stroud steps in fullyher guards tense in the corridor behind her.

PALOMA STROUD
No more running, Dr. Bennett. Ready to explain the real reason you sabotaged our relay?

Fiona tightens her grip on the wheelchair handles behind Derek Takahashi, forcing herself to steady.

FIONA BENNETT
For once, I'm not lying to protect myself. You're endangering everyone with what you're hiding in this lab.

Paloma laughs softlycold and confident.

PALOMA STROUD

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Your family has hidden far worse than me
Wouldn't Irina agree?

Derek tries to push himself upright in his chair; sweat beads his brow.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(smiling weakly)
You think anyone buys this? You talk about legacy while people die out there

Paloma waves a hand dismissively toward him but her gaze remains fixed on Fiona.

PALOMA STROUD
How much does he know? About Sector Nine... about your bloodline's little "enhancement" program?

Lucy tremblesthe word "bloodline" making her shrink closer into Fiona's side. Fiona flinches but holds Paloma's stare hard

now.

FIONA BENNETT
I never asked for any of itand I won't let you twist it into leverage against us!

The glass doors behind Paloma slide shut with a pneumatic hisssealing them all inside together under harsh white lights.

INT. DECONTAMINATION CHAMBER CONTINUOUS

Troy Navarro appears at the observation panel outsidea silent shadow peering through reinforced glass as alarms pulse

red around him, uncertainty flickering across his face before he ducks out of sight again.

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Inside: Paloma paces slowly past Derek's wheelchair toward Lucy and Fiona, voice like silk laced with threat

PALOMA STROUD
If you want your daughter safe? Cooperate nowor we'll see if those mythical genetics are inherited after all...

Derek shifts uneasily; Fiona snaps:

FIONA BENNETT
Touch her and I'll show you exactly what my family is capable ofbut it won't be pretty for any of us!

Paloma smirks but hesitatesnot nearly as invincible as she lets on.

INT. UNDERGROUND SAFE HOUSE SURVEILLANCE BAY NIGHT (MINUTES LATER)

Muted blue monitors glow over Troy Navarro's tense silhouette as he keys an encrypted comm-link openvoice clipped but urgent:

TROY NAVARRO
(into mic)
This is Commander Navarro: Section C breach confirmedI need Ashcroft or Kane rerouted here immediately! And activate fail-safes for chamber seven!

Onscreenlive feed shows Irina Petrov moving purposefully down another corridor carrying an ominous metallic case labeled "Bennett Protocol." Troy curses under his breath then slams a fist onto the console.

INT. DECONTAMINATION CHAMBER SAME TIME

A hidden wall speaker crackles overhead: Irina Petrov's cool voice cuts through tension

IRINA PETROV (O. S.)
Dr. Bennett if your loyalty means anythingyou'll open Chamber Seven yourself within five minutes... or Lucy pays for your indecision.

All eyes whip toward Fionathe weight suffocatinga choice no science can fix closing around her throat.

CLOSE ON FIONA'S FACE:
Determined tears rimmed by fear.
Lucy squeezes tighter.
Outside glass: Troy reappears, fists clenched against helplessness.

OVERHEAD ALARM BLARES LOUDER

FADE TO BLACK.
END EPISODE 35

EPISODE 36

INT. UNDERGROUND SAFE HOUSE SURVEILLANCE BAY NIGHT

Blue monitor light flickers across Fiona Bennett's face as she stares at the countdown on a screen: 4:12 4:11

Lucy clings to her, silent tears glistening.

Troy Navarro stands by the door, jaw setwaiting for Fiona's decision, but hiding his own fear.

Derek Takahashi sits hunched near a medkit, fingers twitching with barely contained energy.

FIONA BENNETT

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(voice breaking)
If I open iteven for Lucythey'll unleash whatever they've got in Chamber Seven.

She wipes her eyes roughly and kneels beside Lucy.

FIONA BENNETT (CONT'D)
Lucy listen to me. No matter what happens out thereyou stay behind me, do you understand?

LUCY
(shaky whisper)
I want to go home.

Fiona hugs her tight. Overhead speakers crackle Irina Petrov counts down from four minutes outside their world like a ticking bomb.

TROY NAVARRO
You can't negotiate with Irina now. That case means leverage is gone once you give in.

He meets Fiona's gazea rare tremor of uncertainty betraying him.

TROY NAVARRO (CONT'D)
But if we stallshe'll take it out on Lucy first.
(low)
Let me try something else. There's back-channel access through Level TwoI could reroute power and buy us time

FIONA BENNETT
That won't stop them using my daughter as bait!

She turns abruptly toward Derek as sparks arc across his palmthe air tingling with static heat.

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DEREK TAKAHASHI
(strained; voice low)
There might be another way I felt something when Paloma threatened us before.
(beat)
If I can channel itI might disrupt their comms or surveillance just long enough for Troy to break Lucy out while you block Irina's protocol remotely

He looks up; sweat beads along his brow but his eyes burn determinedly into Fiona's.

FIONA BENNETT
And if you lose control again? If that thing inside takes over?

DEREK TAKAHASHI
Then promise meyou won't let them turn me into one of those things in the woods.
(a soft smile cracks through pain)
Promise me you finish this your way, not theirs.

EXT. BACK ENTRANCE ABANDONED WAREHOUSE NIGHT

Rain drums on rusted metal above an unmarked service hatcha hidden entry lit only by flashes of passing headlights from

distant streets beyond the woods' edge.

Inside: Troy pushes ahead down dripping stairs, pistol raised; Derek staggers after him gripping a small device sparking

blue between trembling fingers; behind them, Fiona leads Lucy close against her sideher free hand clutching an encrypted

tablet loaded with Chamber Seven override codes.

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INT. ABANDONED WAREHOUSE LOADING FLOOR
CONTINUOUS

Stacks of forgotten crates loom like shadows around them; machinery creaks overhead as lightning strobes through

broken windows far above.

Suddenlya loud thud echoes beyond stacks of cargo cages ahead:

CAMILA KANE
(O. S., urgent whisper)
Navarro! This waythe safe room isn't compromised yet! Hurry!

Camila Kane emerges waving frantically from behind steel barrelsface pale beneath rain-soaked hair.

INT. ABANDONED WAREHOUSE MAKESHIFT SAFE ROOM
MOMENTS LATER

Doors slam shut as Camila throws locks and shoves debris against entrances while everyone scrambles insidethe group

breathes raggedly in partial darkness broken only by battered lantern glow and pulsing blue LEDs on Fiona's tablet and

Derek's device.

CAMILA KANE
They're triangulating signals every thirty secondswe don't have much time unless your little genius trick works fast!

She glances sharply at Derek whose hands shake uncontrollably as he connects wires togetherbut then blue arcs leap upward

licking nearby pipes without burning flesh or metal.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

111

(concentrating hard)
Give me guidance protocolsI need coordinates mapped directly onto external lines
(breath hitching)

Fiona slides next to him entering rapid commandsas alarms begin echoing faintly outside the barricade:

FIONA BENNETT
You're overriding feedback loopsnot brute forcingit has to look accidental or they'll trigger lockdown protocols!

Their faces inches apart over tangled circuitsinvisible tension thrumming between urgency and something unspoken.

EXTREME CLOSE ON TROY NAVARRO watchingthe weight of choice pressing harder than any threat outside:

FLASHING LED READOUT JUMPS
Signal jammed!
Static floods every monitor feed just long enough

Camila gasps,
"You did itthat window's all we get!"

Without warningthe building rocks violently
Screams ring out nearby;
from within darknessbeastlike shapes snarl at outer doors,
Chamber Seven may be unlockedor unleashed already

SMASH TO BLACK
END EPISODE 36

EPISODE 37

INT. UNDERGROUND SAFE HOUSE COMMAND CENTER NIGHT

112

Fiona's eyes widen as the building shakes violently. Nearby, screams echo through the darkness.

FIONA BENNETT
(panicked)
The chamber it's unlocked!

Her gaze snaps to Lucy, frozen in terror.

LUCY (V. O.)
Momrun! Don't look back!

Before Fiona can react, monstrous figures emerge from the shadows outside.

Their snarls fill the air

And then suddenlythe sound cuts off completely.

Everyone freezes. The room falls into an eerie silence.

CAMILA STRUD (ALARMED)
What just happened?

TROY NAVARRO (CAUTIOUS)
(intense)
They're retreatingfor now. But we haven't seen their alpha yet. Once he arrives

His voice trails off as a deep growl reverberates through the facility.

Everyone turns toward Chamber Seven where a massive shadow looms behind its translucent door glass.

Then with a thunderous crashthe heavy steel grate slams down and locks into placesealing them inside once more.

SMASH CUT
To black

113

END EPISODE 37

EPISODE 38

INT. UNDERGROUND SAFE HOUSE CHAMBER SEVEN ANTEROOM NIGHT

A cold, metallic silence presses against the walls. The steel grate glows faintly with emergency lights. Fiona Bennett

stands between Lucy and Derek Takahashiher breath ragged, eyes scanning for movement.

TROY NAVARRO paces in front of the sealed door, jaw clenched.

FIONA BENNETT
(whispering)
Is it gone? Or just waiting for us to make the wrong move?

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(strained)
It's still there. I can feel it through the wall.

Lucy clings to Fiona, silent tears on her cheek.

CAMILA KANE creeps closer, voice trembling.

CAMILA KANE
We're trapped! Does anyone have a plan that isn't justwaiting to be eaten?

Troy shoots her a glare but stays focused on the door mechanism.

TROY NAVARRO
If we open this without authorization, Irina will trigger lockdown protocols across every exit.
(to Fiona)

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You realize what Chamber Seven holds? If you release it

Fiona cuts him offher voice brittle but defiant.

FIONA BENNETT
If I do nothing, my daughter dies anyway.
(low)
Don't talk to me about consequences until you decide whose side you're really on.

Derek's hands twitch; blue sparks flicker at his fingertips as he steadies Lucy with a gentle touch. She flinchesbut something

in Derek's gaze soothes her panic momentarily.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
Fiona whatever's behind that chamberit's responding to more than security codes.
(softly)
It wants connection. Otherwise it would have ripped through by now. I think I could distract itbut not for long.

Camila backs away anxiously as a deep thud reverberates from inside Chamber Seventhe alpha beast testing its prison again.

INT. UNDERGROUND SAFE HOUSE SMALL SUPPLY CLOSET MOMENTS LATER

Fiona yanks open plastic bins: bandages, old comms unitsthen freezes at a battered notebook marked "Ashcroft."

She flips pages urgentlyschematics of Chamber Seven overlayed with handwritten warnings: "Alpha only responds under

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direct neural stimulus." Her hand shakes; she snaps the book shut and stares into space, torn by indecision.

INT. UNDERGROUND SAFE HOUSE CHAMBER SEVEN ANTEROOM CONTINUOUS

Lucy sits hunched next to Derek now; Troy stands guard by Camila at the distant end of the room.

Derek looks up as Fiona re-enters holding Ashcroft's notebook tight against her chesta resolve hardening in her jawline.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
Did you find something?

FIONA BENNETT
(nearly monotone)
The alpha isn't controlled remotelyit bonds neurologically when threatened.
(glances at Lucy)
If anyone gets close enough they might guide its actions directlyor die trying.

CAMILA KANE
That isn't an option!
(turns desperately to Troy)
Tell her! Don't let some monster hijack

Troy doesn't answer immediatelyhis guard down just half an inch as he studies Fiona's face instead of Camila's outburst.

TROY NAVARRO
(low)
What are you planning?
Who gets sacrificed firstyou or your kid?

EXTREME CLOSE-UP: FIONA'S HANDS trembling around Ashcroft's notesfor an instant she nearly tears them apart.

LUCY (SMALL VOICE)

116

MomI want this over toobut don't leave me alone.

Something breaks behind Fiona's eyes; determination sets back in place like armor.

INT. UNDERGROUND SAFE HOUSE CHAMBER SEVEN DOORWAY SHORT TIME LATER

The heavy chamber humsthey prepare improvised restraints and wiring guided by Ashcroft's sketches spread beside them on cracked tile floor.

Derek kneels beside Fiona amid skeins of wire and crude tech scavenged from storage.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

Let me try firstI'm less important if things go wrong.

He meets Troy Navarro's eyesnot afraid but pleading for trust.

Suddenlythe sound system crackles overhead: IRINA PETROV'S filtered voice broadcast throughout:

IRINA PETROV (O. S.)

You have sixty seconds remaining before full purge sequence initiates.

Everyone tenses.

CAMILA KANE

She'll kill everyone!

LUCY grabs hold of Fiona tighter than ever.

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For one desperate heartbeatall possibilities hang suspended:

Will she risk herselfor gamble everything on Derek?

END EPISODE 38

EPISODE 39

INT. UNDERGROUND SAFE HOUSE CHAMBER SEVEN DOORWAY NIGHT

Ashcroft's sketches litter the floor. Wires and improvised tech sprawl across broken tile.

Fiona Bennett glances at Lucy, then Derek Takahashi, torn.

CAMILA KANE
(voice tight)
We're running out of time!

The overhead system ticks down Irina's voice crackling above:

IRINA PETROV (O. S.)
Forty seconds remaining.

Troy Navarro looms beside Fiona, jaw set.

TROY NAVARRO
(decisive)
You don't have to do this

FIONA BENNETT
(interrupting, cold clarity)
If I let him tryif anything happens Lucy pays the price.

Derek steadies her with a look: gentle but unwavering.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

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Fi. I know the risks. Let me make this choice for oncenot you protecting everyone else.

Lucy clings tighter, near tears.

LUCY
(murmuring)
Mom please

IRINA PETROV (O. S.)
Thirty seconds remaining. Initiate sequence or face terminal purge protocol.

Camila fumbles desperately with a cable; sparks hop from metal to stone as she connects power lines per Fiona's nod.

Fiona moves toward Derek slowlya decision solidifying within her gazethen stops inches away from Troy Navarro's shadow

blocking her path.

She looks up into his eyes: years of tension in a heartbeat between them.

FIONA BENNETT
(low)
This isn't your call anymore, Troy. Stand asideor help us survive what comes next.

INT. UNDERGROUND SAFE HOUSE CHAMBER SEVEN
INTERIOR CONTINUOUS

Derek lowers himself onto makeshift restraints near the alpha beast containment chambera monstrous silhouette

pulses behind thick glass as red lights flicker on its skin.

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Wires snake from his exposed wrist and temple; Camila stands ready by an old relay switch.

Troy watches every motion, conflicted rage warring with fear beneath tightly clenched fists.

CAMILA KANE
Ready when you areI'll trigger on your sign.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(smiling faintly at Fiona)
Count me in.

He braces himself as electrical current surges through crude connectionsthe beast thrashes behind glass in empathic

response.

Lucy buries her face against Fiona's side as energy crackles dangerously through wires to Derek's body.

INT. UNDERGROUND SAFE HOUSE CONTROL SCRAP STATION SAME TIME

Paloma Stroud's image flashes briefly on a battered monitora silent reminder of threats outside these wallsbut Irina's

countdown drowns everything out:

IRINA PETROV (O. S.)
Ten... nine...

INT. UNDERGROUND SAFE HOUSE CHAMBER SEVEN INTERIOR

Electricity arcs along Derek's arms; suddenly he gives a strangled gaspthe alpha beast ceases all movement for one

breathless moment

His eyes roll back and then snap open: pupils slit like the creature itself.

CAMILA KANE
(vibrating panic)
What is he seeing? Is it working?

TROY NAVARRO steps forward impulsively but restrains himself just short of intervening.

FIONA BENNETT
(sharply)
Let him focus!

Through labored breaths:

DEREK TAKAHASHI

There are more outside hungry angrybut scared too

(TENSES HEAD SHARPLY)
They feel methey think I'm kinthey
(his hands tremble violently)

Suddenly alarms blare louder than before; distant scraping echoes down unseen tunnels outside Chamber Seven.

LUCY

(TERRIFIED WHISPER)
Make it stop...

Red light paints everyone's facespower grid shuddersas panels spark ominously above.

IRINA PETROV (O. S.)
Purge sequence interrupted by foreign override code.
Who has accessed my systems?

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Everyone freezesa new threat stirs awake in Irina's networked domainand FIONA locks eyes with TROY amid chaos:

FIONA BENNETT

(whispers fiercely to Troy while staring at sparking door controls)
Now is our only chanceyou trust me?

He hesitatesa rare flicker of something vulnerable underneath grim resolve

Then finally nods: nothing left but faith or destruction between them.

CUT TO
Black on the moment they move in unison toward the doors
END EPISODE 39

EPISODE 40

EXT. RESEARCH LAB PERIMETER - NIGHT

Fiona moves cautiously along the edge of the forest, flashlight cutting through thick fog. The distant howls echo.

TROY steps out from behind a tree, gun raised but lowered when he sees her.

TROY
You shouldn't be out here alone.

FIONA
I'm tracking that creature's trail. It's closetoo close to the lab perimeter.

TROY
And you think wandering deeper into monster territory is safer?

She doesn't answer, eyes fixed on disturbed ground near twisted roots.

122

Suddenly, a low growl rumbles nearby. Fiona freezes; Troy raises his weapon instantly.

DEREK appears at the clearing entrance with a tranquilizer rifle slung over his shoulder.

DEREK
Heard noises too. Thought I'd check in before things got worse.

FIONA
Good timing. Look at these claw marksthey're fresh and heading this way fast.

TROY scans the trees nervously as fog thickens around them all three.

TROY
We need to get back insidenow!

FIONA shakes her head stubbornly, stepping closer to an ominous set of prints leading toward dense brush.

FIONA
If we don't understand what we're dealing with, it'll keep coming back... stronger each time.

INT. LAB CONTROL ROOM - LATER

The trio surrounds monitors showing thermal images of movement just beyond fences where sensors flicker erratically.

DEREK taps on keyboard rapidly while Fiona studies data readouts intensely.

DEREK
It's not just one creature anymorethere are multiple heat signatures converging on us.

123

TROY clenches jaw tightly watching live feeds of shadowy figures slipping between trees.

TROY
Security teams aren't enough if they breach again like last week...

FIONA looks up sharply with resolve burning in her eyes.

FIONA
Then we adapt our strategywe lure them away using bait outside their usual paths...

DEREK nods approvingly but glances worriedly toward Troy who remains silent for a beat before speaking:

TROY
Finebut if anything goes wrong out there

He stops himself and exhales deeply without finishing the threat aloud.

EXT. FOREST EDGE - DAWN

Fog lifts slowly revealing makeshift traps laid carefully by Derek and Fiona near broken branches and animal carcasses used as bait.

They crouch silently waiting; Troy stands guard scanning shadows relentlessly.

Suddenly rustling sounds erupt from bushes opposite their position then two monstrous forms burst forward snarling fiercely.

Fiona grabs Derek's arm pulling him behind cover as Troy fires warning shots into air trying to intimidate creatures.

124

One beast lunges directly at Fiona she dodges narrowly falling backward onto soft moss.

Her breath quickens; heart pounding fiercely she locks eyes with its glowing amber gaze right before it pauses abruptly then retreats into darkness.

INT. LAB INFIRMARY - MORNING

Bruised but alive, Fiona sits bandaged while Troy watches anxiously nearby holding coffee cups for both of them.

DEREK enters carrying samples collected during night watch smiling softly at Fiona's resilience.

DEREK
You pushed yourself too hard again... but you did good out there today.

She manages a tired smile looking between Derek and Troy who exchange guarded glances across room.

FIONA
We've only bought ourselves timenot safety yetand whatever those things are planning next won't wait long...

Her voice trails off as tension fills room quietly except for distant alarms sounding faintly outside once more.

CUT TO
BLACK
END EPISODE 40

EPISODE 41

INT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX NIGHT

125

Fiona, now dressed in tactical gear, strides purposefully through the rusted corridors of a long-abandoned factory. The

air is thick with dust and decay. She holds a map under her flashlight, scanning every detail.

Suddenly, she freezes as her phone buzzesan incoming message from Irina.

IRINA (V. O.)
The creatures halted their purge last night. You've successfully disrupted them.

Fiona's eyes narrow at the screen.

FIONA
(to herself)
Disrupted? That means they're still out there planning something else.

She tucks the phone away and quickens her pace toward an exit sign flickering weakly in the darkness.

EXT. ROOFTOP GARDEN OF A HIGH-RISE BUILDING NIGHT

Under a sky smeared with city lights, Fiona steps onto the rooftop gardena rare patch of green atop cold steeland finds

Troy waiting by a bench overlooking the skyline. His expression is unreadable but his posture tense.

TROY
You didn't call to chat about flowers or fresh air, did you?

Before Fiona can respond, Derek emerges from behind some bushes nearby; he looks differenthis eyes glinting unnaturally

126

sharp in the moonlight, movements too fluid for human comfort.

DEREK
(voice low)
We need to talk... alone.
He gestures subtly towards another corner of the garden where shadows gather more deeply than elsewhere.
Fiona hesitates but follows him without protest.
Once isolated in shadowed seclusion:
Derek exhales slowly before speaking again
DEREK (CONT'D)
Since merging with that alpha beast... I feel like I'm losing myselfto it.
My control over my own body feels weaker each day...
I fear what might happen if this continues.
His voice trembles slightlynot from weakness but internal conflict.
Just then distant footsteps echo faintly near building entrance below,
breaking their conversation abruptly into alert tension.

END EPISODE 41

EPISODE 42

INT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX NIGHT

Fiona and Derek freeze, instinctively gripping concealed weapons beneath their coats.

From the shadows emerges a tall figure Paloma Stroud, flanked by two heavily armed guards.

PALOMA
(smirking)

127

Well, well what a surprise to find you here. Looks like my invitation reached its intended guests after all.

Derek's eyes narrow as he steps protectively in front of Fiona.

DEREK
What are you doing? This isn't your territory anymore!

PALOMA
(tilting her head)
Oh, but it is. Everything still belongs to methe shadows, the secrets... and now this little game we're playing together.

She gestures toward the building entrance behind them where more figures begin to emerge from the darkness Lucy first among them, followed by Mark Langston and several other familiar faces from Sector 6.

LUCY
(frowning)
Mother?

FIONA
(coldly surprised)
You came too?

The group moves closer under Paloma's command. Lucy glances between Fiona and Paloma with growing confusion before stepping forward hesitantly.

LUCY (CONT'D)
Mom who is she?

BEFORE FIONA CAN ANSWER

128

Suddenly Troy Navarro bursts through a side door at full sprint. His expression is fierce with urgency as he skids to a

stop beside Lucy's group. His gun trained on Paloma and her guards without hesitation.

TROY
(to everyone)
Everyone stay calm! This meeting ends now!

He presses his lips into a thin line and slowly lowers his weapon towards Palomanot out of submission but calculated intent.

PALOMA
(smiling coldly)

So predictable...

Their eyes lock; tension snaps taut across the room like an invisible wire about to break.

[Note: The next episode will continue.]

END EPISODE 42

EPISODE 43

INT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX NIGHT

The group freezes at TROY's arrival. PALOMA'S smile doesn't falter, but her eyes flash with irritation.

PALOMA
(annoyed)
Troy Navarro Always so dramatic.

TROY steps forward and lowers his weapon completely, but the tension remains thick in the air.

129

TROY
(firmly)
No one moves until this meeting is officially over. Understood?

Lucy stares at Troy, confused by the sudden shift in dynamics between him and Fionathen glances nervously back to Paloma.

LUCY (V. O.)
Why does he seem more afraid of her than anyone else?

FIONA watches them both coolly, arms crossed as she studies their interaction like a chess player eyeing an opponent's move.

FIONA (COLDLY)
So you're here to protect Ms. Stroud? Or me?

Her gaze flicks briefly toward Lucy before locking onto Troy againchallenging him openly for control of the situation.

DEREK, standing beside her, senses something shifting beneath their usual banterthe unspoken power struggleand instinctively moves closer to Fiona for support. His presence unsettles Paloma visibly; she shifts uneasily under Derek's watchful glare.

PALOMA (SMIRKING)

Neither needs protection anymore... not from meor certainly not from each other.
She waves dismissively toward Lucy and Camila with deliberate malice.
As if they were mere afterthoughts.

130

Dismissal hangs heavy in the stale industrial air

SUDDENLY

A sharp metallic clang echoes through the hallways outsidea distant sound that cuts through the tension like a knife. Everyone

turns toward it instinctivelyALARMEDbut no one speaks aloud yet...

PALOMA (SNAPPING)
Enough playing games!

With a quick motion, she gestures sharply at her guards behind her two shadowy figures step forward immediately closing

distance between themselves and LUCY & CAMILA , surrounding them menacingly .

LUCY & CAMILA freeze instantly . Their eyes dart around frantically searching for escape routes . Fear radiates off them

visibly nowbut neit her makes a move

Fiona exhales slowly , calculating silently before stepping forward decisively :

FIONA
(calm yet commanding)
I won't let you hurt innocent people just because you feel entitled . This ends here right now .

She locks eyes once again on Paloma ; unwavering resolve radiating outward like steel forged light

Paloma lets out another low chuckle then suddenly spins on heel without warning

131

And storms straight into Fiona ' s chest with brutal force .

BEFORE ANYONE CAN REACT

Their bodies collide violently , sending both crashing hard against nearest wall A loud CRASH follows as debris tumbies down around them

The room erupts into chaos

Guards rush forward immediately trying to separate combatants while screams break loose all around

Everyone scrambles desperately trying regain control amid mounting confusion

END EPISODE 43

EPISODE 44

INT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX NIGHT

The guards rush to separate Fiona and Paloma, but their struggle is fierce. Suddenly, one guard pulls out a baton and strikes Paloma hard across the back.

GUARD 1
Enough! This ends now!

Paloma staggers forward, collapsing against the wall with a pained grunt. She glares venomously at Fiona as she tries to regain her composure.

PALOMA (V. O.)
Damn it... I should've finished this myself...

132

Fiona steadies herself against the debris-strewn wall, eyes locked on Paloma with unwavering resolve.

FIONA
This time you crossed a line no one will forgive.

Before Paloma can respond, Lucy suddenly steps forward between them trembling but resolute.

LUCY
Mom! Don't hurt each other anymore! Please!

Camila mirrors Lucy's stance beside her both girls' eyes filled with terror yet determination. The room falls silent in

that moment.

PALOMA (SNAPPING)
Lucy?! So you've been here all along?

Lucy's expression flickers briefly before hardening into defiance.

LUCY
Yes. And I'm not going anywhere without my mother by my side!

Fiona exhales sharply worry flashes across her features for just an instant before steeling herself again toward Lucy's

opponent standing mere feet away

FIONA (LOW & FIRM)
You're nothing more than a threat to my family now Once we get through tonight's chaos , I'll make sure you pay for what you've donewhether it means locking you away or ending your miserable existence forever .

133

Paloma grits her teeth tightly then spins on heel

Her cold glare sweeping over every single person still standing around as she raises voice deliberately loud enough for

everyone present

PALOMA (SHARP & COMMANDING)
Guardsescort these two brats back inside . Now !

Two guards immediately step forward again grabbing hold of Lucy and Camila roughly from either side . The girls scream in

protest , struggling fiercely amid desperate cries .

LUCKY / CAMILA (SCREAMING IN UNISON)
No ! Let go of us ! Mom !!

The guards forcefully drag them backward toward exit doors where darkness looms beyond its threshold . Their frail bodies

thrash violently against restraints as they are shoved mercilessly onward without mercy

And once those heavy doors finally slam shut behind them silence consumes everything else left within that space .

TENSION HANGS THICKLY IN THE AIR

THEN SLOWLY

THE ROOM ERUPTS INTO CHAOS AGAIN AS PALOMA TURNS SHARPLY BACK TO FIONA WITH A VICIOUS SMIRK

END EPISODE 44

EPISODE 45

134

INT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX NIGHT

The room descends into chaos as Paloma's gaze snaps to the guards, her voice sharp and commanding.

PALOMA
Seize themnow!

Two guards immediately step forward again, grabbing Lucy and Camila roughly from either side. The girls scream in protest,

struggling fiercely amid desperate cries.

LUCKY / CAMILA
No! Let go of us! Mom!!

The guards forcefully drag them backward toward exit doors where darkness looms beyond its threshold. Their frail bodies

thrash violently against restraints as they are shoved mercilessly onward without mercy

And once those heavy doors finally slam shut behind them silence consumes everything else left within that space.

TENSION HANGS THICKLY IN THE AIR

THEN SLOWLY

THE ROOM ERUPTS INTO CHAOS AGAIN AS PALOMA TURNS SHARPLY BACK TO FIONA WITH A VICIOUS SMIRK

INT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX MAIN HALL CONTINUOUS

Fiona's eyes blaze with fury as she lunges at Paloma, but before she can close the distance

TROY (V. O.)
Enough!

135

A single gunshot rings out sharply through the hall.

Everyone freezes instantlythe sound echoing ominously in the enclosed space. Fiona instinctively drops to one knee,

clutching her side where a bullet wound bleeds steadily onto her clothing.

FIONA (PANICKED)
Oh my god... I'm hit...

She stares down at herself in disbelief while Paloma steps forward calmly toward Troy with an arrogant smirk on her facebut

then suddenly stops mid-step when Troy raises his hand abruptly stop signally for silence.

Troy's cold blue eyes lock viciously onto Fiona like he could tear right through her soulbefore finally turning back toward

Paloma with calculated composure.

TROY (COLD & UNMOVED)
Paloma... You've crossed a line this time. We don't negotiate with terrorists or traitorsand you just shot Commander Bennett without any warning or justification whatsoever .

His words hang heavily in the airthe weight of authority radiating from him like steel pressure surrounding everyone

present .

PALOMA (SMILING DARKLY)
I didn't shoot anyoneI ordered those men to remove these two dangerous women . And if someone got hurt during transportation , that's their problem .

136

Her gaze flicks dismissively over Fiona's form before settling arrogantly back on Troywith barely concealed venom beneath

every syllable .

PALOMA
(cont'd)
(LOW & MENACING)
As for you your pathetic attachment makes you weak . You're nothing more than a tool nowa disposable pawn easily discarded once we finish what we came here for !

Her words cut deep each sentence deliberately designed to provoke to strip away whatever remaining pride or composure

might still cling faintly within him after all this humiliation

But instead of lashing out , Troy merely tilts his head slightly sideways allowing himself one slow breath then another

UNTIL FINALLY

He locks eyes dead center with hers again , voice dropping low enough only she can hear clearly :

TROY (SOFT BUT LOADED )
Paloma This isn't about loyalty anymore . It never was not between usit was always business first . But now there are emotions involved . And emotions cloud judgmentthey make people reckless ... and dangerous ...

He leans ever so slightly closer towards her , barely breathing against skin .

His whisper carries no warmth whatsoever yet feels unnervingly intimate :

TROY(CONT'D)

137

If anything happens to Ms. Lucy or Miss Cameron because of your stupidity todayI swear by everything sacred I hold dearI'll make sure you regret it until your last breath !

Their gazes remain locked tightly together for several long seconds; neit her dares break eye contact lest something

irreversible happen next

FINALLY

With deliberate slowness , he straightens upright completely again ; voice cold and formal once more ;

TROY SMOOTH COMMAND TONE]

Guards ! Escort Ms. Bennett inside immediately ! Secure every inch around Chamber Seven perimeter starting now ! No

exceptions !

The two Guards snap into action instantly ; moving swiftly towards Fiona ; gripping firmly underarms lifting upwards carefully

but efficiently --carrying off their wounded commander without hesitation--

Palomas lips tighten visibly at witnessing such absolute control demonstrated publicly by Navarro despite obvious

personal conflict simmering beneath surface tension between old acquaintances turned enemies...

She turns heel sharply afterwardher dark silhouette dissolving quickly into shadowed corridors faraway depths beyond

immediate range-of-vision-clearance zone limits

138

ONLY SILENCE REMAINS BEHIND

EXCEPT -

One lone figure stands frozen momentarily near entranceway corner : Emily Ashcroft clutches camera tightly against chestas

trembling fingers begin raising lens methodically upwardto capture each unfolding detail relentlessly

frame-by-frame...

Emily watches silently through viewfinder until final image solidifies perfectly clear -

Before lowering device quietlyand discreetly slipping unnoticed back beneath coat pocket folds without drawing

attention from anyone nearby scene surroundings alike

END EPISODE 45

EPISODE 46

INT. UNDERGROUND MEDICAL FACILITY RECOVERY SUITE NIGHT

Harsh white light glows overhead. Fiona Bennett blinks awake, face pale, sweat beading her brow.

Camila Kane leans over her with a med kit in hand, anxiety written clear.

CAMILA KANE
Stay stilljust another second

Fiona winces as Camila tightens a bandage around her wound.

FIONA BENNETT
(gritted)

139

Where's Lucy? Is she safe?

CAMILA KANE
(soft but urgent)
Paloma took them She's moving fast. We're locked in for nowbut you need to rest or the stitches will tear out.

Fiona tries to push herself upright; the pain nearly doubles her over. Camila gently restrains herthis time with only a touch and pleading eyes.

Footsteps approach from beyond bulletproof glassthe security door slides open with a hiss.

INT. UNDERGROUND MEDICAL FACILITY OBSERVATION DECK CONTINUOUS

Troy Navarro enters, flanked by two silent guards who remain outside. His coat is immaculate; his expression ice-cold save for one sharply furrowed brow.

He stands above Fiona, gaze steely but voice low enough to avoid betraying emotion to anyone else listening in.

TROY NAVARRO
You should have let them handle extraction protocol instead of rushing Paloma yourself.
(pauses)
But it's done now.
(beat)
I'm mobilizing every asset we have left on Lucy and Camila's trail.

FIONA BENNETT
That won't work if Paloma moves underground againor worse

140

She grimaces as another wave of pain hitsa stubborn resolve lighting behind exhausted eyes.

FIONA BENNETT (CONT'D)
Don't treat me like I'm finished here. I'll coordinate from bed if I have to.

INT. TROY NAVARRO'S URBAN PENTHOUSE APARTMENT NIGHT

Sparse modern lines frame floor-to-ceiling windows overlooking distant city lights below forest shadows at the horizon edge.

Troy stares at surveillance screens showing grainy footage: Lucy and Camila bound together in an armored van; Paloma

issuing rapid-fire orders off-screen audio feed crackling faintly through speakers.

Jack Tanaka stands nearby holding encrypted fileswaiting for authorization codes that never come right away.

JACK TANAKA
Sir
We intercepted chatter about movement near Old Timberline Road.
That matches Derek Takahashi's last pingsignal was erratic but persistent before dropping entirely three hours ago.

TROY NAVARRO
Keep tracking anything related to Takahashi or the Alpha mutation project.
If he loses control out thereit won't just be our problem anymore.

EXT. FOREST EDGE OUTSKIRTS OF CITY LATE NIGHT

The trees bristle under starlight blurred by rolling mist; branches twist into shadows deeper than night itself.

141

Derek Takahashi paces alone among gnarled roots, breath coming harsh and uneventhe alpha beast pulse thrumming underneath

skin threatening rupture at any wrong step.

He closes his eyes tighthands digging into bark deep enough that blood beads beneath claws half-formed.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(intense whisperto himself)
Steady It can't own meI decideI decide when this ends

Emily Ashcroft emerges cautiously between treesa camera slung at hip level this timenot pointed yet forward but steadying

herself as an ally not observer.

EMILY ASHCROFT

(SOTTO VOCE)

You're losing yourself again?

DEREK TAKAHASHI

NoI'm fighting back tonight.

He looks up suddenly: golden irises flicker before softening again toward Emily's anxious silhouette.

DEREK TAKAHASHI (CONT'D)

Tell FionaI haven't given up on controlling what she started inside mebut if I fail

(TRAILS OFF)

Emily nods gravely.

142

BACK TO:

INT. UNDERGROUND MEDICAL FACILITY FIONA'S SUITE MOMENTS LATER

Fiona sits propped up by pillows nowa data tablet shaking slightly in bloody hands as she pulls blueprints onto screen display;

veins standing out along neck with effort.

CAMILA KANE

(STRICKEN)

Pleaseyou're pushing too hard!

FIONA BENNETT

If they want warthey picked the wrong scientist.

The glass door hisses open:

DEREK TAKAHASHI (O. S.)

Let her try.

Everyone whirls as Derek appears unannouncedmuddy boots marking sterile tilea strange aura following him like

living shadow.

His smile wavers on something barely humanbut his voice remains warm, trembling under strain:

DEREK TAKAHASHI

We don't get another shot after tonight.

OFF their tense facesthe fragile alliance newly reforged under desperate terms

143

As alarms begin blinking red across medical monitors,
and footsteps thunder above,

the team braces for counterattackwith everything fractured riding on Fiona's wounded determination,

FADE OUT

.

END EPISODE 46

EPISODE 47

INT. ABANDONED INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX NIGHT

The sharp echo of footsteps reverberates through the dim corridor.

FIONA (V. O.)
This place is a death trap but no way I'm letting them take Lucy and Camila.

She steadies herself, eyes hardening as she grips her sideblood seeps through her fingersbut she forces herself to stand taller.

FIONA
(voice low, fierce)
Let's finish this tonight. No more games.

Her gaze flicks to Dereka mixture of command and desperation.

FIONA (CONT'D)
Derek, prep the counterattack plan. We strike at dawn when their guard drops. And keep an eye on TroyI don't trust him for a second after what he just did to me.

DEREK
(nods quickly)
Understood. I'll handle it

144

Suddenly, distant shouts cut through the silencethe sound of reinforcements arriving for Paloma's team.

TROY'S VOICE rings out from abovecold and calculated:

TROY (O. S.)
You'll regret crossing me like this!

Panic flashes across Fiona's face before she masks it with steely resolve. She turns sharply toward Derek and Cami

without hesitation.

FIONA
Get Lucy out of here now! Use every back exit we haveno mistakes!

CAMILA & DEREK nod instantly before breaking into a run down separate hallways as Fiona watches them go,

her expression unreadable beneath exhaustion and pain.
Then slowly turning toward where TROY's voice still echoes,
a dark determination settling in her eyes.

FADE OUT

.

END EPISODE 47

EPISODE 48

INT. UNDERGROUND MEDICAL FACILITY ISOLATION BAY NIGHT

Fiona Bennett's breath is shallow, hooked to monitors, wrapped in pristine white sheets. Soft medical lights pulse

overhead.

145

She winces as she tries to sit upher wound protests sharply.

A glass wall separates her from the corridor beyond. Her reflection stares back: exhausted but unbroken.

CAMILA KANE appears outside the glass, hesitation written across her face.

FIONA BENNETT
(voice hoarse)
Don't stand there like I'm contagious. Get in hereI need status on Lucy and Derek now.

Camila swipes an access card; the door slides open with a hiss.

CAMILA KANE
Lucy's safe Derek got them out through sublevel four.
(beat)
But he hasn't come back yet. He said he needed airhe looked... different when he left.

Fiona swings her legs off the bed, teeth gritted against pain.

FIONA BENNETT
"Different" how? Camilatell me exactly what you saw.

CAMILA KANE
Eyes black as pitch. And his skinthe veins under it They were moving.
(softly)
He promised not to lose control.

The monitor beeps faster as Fiona processes this new threateven among allies.

INT. TROY NAVARRO'S PENTHOUSE APARTMENT NIGHT

146

Floor-to-ceiling windows reveal a cold city skyline glinting with rain-soaked neon below. Troy Navarro stands at a sleek metal table littered with security feeds and dossiers marked "BENNETT," "TAKAHASHI," "KANE."

His phone buzzesa secure line blinking red.

TROY NAVARRO
(into phone; clipped)
Status?

GRANT LANGSTON (V. O.)
Her team made it into Sector Delta, sirbut Takahashi went dark near Grid 7B exit.
We lost visual after that You want us to move on Bennett directly?

Troy's jaw tightens as lightning flashes outside the window, illuminating unreadable eyes reflected in glass.

TROY NAVARRO
Not yet.
They'll lead us straight to their fallback nest if we're patientand desperate prey always make mistakes.
(inhales slowly)
Tell Paloma: full lockdown by sunrise.
And if Takahashi resurfaces
(colder still)
He comes down alive.

EXT. DENSE FOREST OUTSKIRTS NIGHT

Branches whip by as Derek Takahashi runs blindly beneath towering pines deeper into shadowed woods just beyond city limits.

147

His body jerks and spasms mid-stridea guttural snarl rips from his throat before he clamps a trembling hand over his mouth,

fighting for composure against something monstrous within him.

FLASHES of memory flicker:
-- Fiona's pale blood-stained hand clutching his arm,
-- Lucy's terrified eyes,
-- Troy's cold promise of regret echoing behind clenched teeth

Derek collapses at the base of an ancient tree, nails digging into earth so hard they bleed blackish fluid instead of

normal blood.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(broken whisper, pleading with himself)
Stay human you don't get to run now

Suddenlybranches snap behind him: moonlight catches two animalistic yellow eyes watching just out of sight.

INT. UNDERGROUND MEDICAL FACILITY ISOLATION BAY LATER THAT NIGHT

Fiona forces herself upright again despite Camila's worried protests; sweat glistens on her brow from painbut she is focused

only on strategy boards spread around her bedside: creature movement logs and sketches dot every surface.

CAMILA KANE
You should restyou can barely sit up!

FIONA BENNETT
Rest when our people stop running for their lives!
(pen scratches furiously across maps)

148

If Paloma locks down Sector Delta then Troy moves nextwe need leverage or we're boxed in three directions by dawn

Suddenly an alert blaresa perimeter breach warning flashing crimson above her head:

INTRUSION DETECTED SECTOR FOURTEEN

Camila gasps; Fiona clutches at bandages over her ribs but doesn't hesitate,

LOCKS EYES WITH CAMILA

FIONA BENNETT
That could be Derekor something much worse.
(gets shakily to feet)
Get every sensor feed patched through here now! We are not waiting for them this time

The camera lingers on Fiona framed by glowing screensa mix of agony and defiance etched deepas fear builds over whomor

whatis coming through those doors next

FADE OUT

.

END EPISODE 48

EPISODE 49

INT. UNDERGROUND MEDICAL FACILITY ISOLATION BAY NIGHT

The overhead light flickers, casting shadows across the sterile room where Fiona's face is pale under the harsh

glare. Monitors beep steadily in rhythm with her shallow breaths.

TROYS VOICE (O. S.)
Fiona Bennett... you've crossed a line that can't be undone.

149

The door slides open silently, and Troy Navarro steps inhis presence cold and commanding. He stops at the foot of her

bed, eyes darkening as he tilts his head slightly to look down on her.

TROY NAVARRO
(seething)
After all this you still oppose me?

Fiona clenches her jaw through the pain but refuses to meet his gaze directly.

FIONA BENNETT
(weak yet defiant)
I'm not done fightingfor them or for what's right...

Her voice trails off as weakness overtakes it, but Troy remains unmoved by sentimentality.

He pulls out a sleek remote from his coat pocket and presses a buttonlights dim instantly. A holographic map projects

above the bedside table, glowing red zones pulsing ominously around Sector Fourteenthe breach point now flashing

scarlet.

CAMILA KANE (O. S.)
Sir! The sensors are patched!

Troy glances briefly toward Camila entering behind him before stepping closer to Fiona once more. His fingers brush

against hersnot tenderlybut with possessive finality.

TROY NAVARRO
This ends tonight... if you surrender control of Sector Fourteen back to usI might consider sparing your life

150

His lips curl into an icy smirk before turning sharply on his heel and exiting without another word.

CAMILA KANE
(frowning nervously)
Should we activate emergency lockdown protocols?

FIONA BENNETT
(grim determination)
They're here for Derekand they won't leave until one of us falls first.
(eyes narrowing)
Camilawe take no prisoners tonight.
She steadies herself painfully against the faint ringing in her ears, staring hard at every blinking sensor feed in front of them.

Suddenlythe main entrance bursts open with violent force

DEREK TAKAHASHI stands framed in shadowed doorwaya monstrous figure half-consumed by wolfish transformation; fur patches

mottled across human skin; claws scraping lightly along steel floor tiles; amber eyes burning fiercely beneath tangled

locks of hair

He scans quicklyand then freezes upon seeing Fiona lying weakly among scattered bandages and medical equipment

HIS BREATH HITCHES
Then suddenlya sharp growl escapes deep within him

DEREK LUNGES FORWARD

And everything goes black.

FADE OUT

END EPISODE 49

151

EPISODE 50

INT. UNDERGROUND MEDICAL FACILITY ISOLATION BAY NIGHT

The room is dim, a single overhead light flickering sporadically. Fiona lies on the bed, eyes half-lidded, body trembling with exhaustion.

A faint hum of machinery fills the airmonitors beep steadily in rhythm with her shallow breath.

Suddenlythe door swings open sharply

TROY NAVARRO enters without knocking, his gaze cold and unreadable.

He crosses to her side silently, standing over her like an executioner.

FIONA (V. O.)

So this is how it ends trapped like prey in its den

She clenches her fists beneath the blanket but remains still under his steely stare.

TROY

(LOW VOICE)

You've been run ragged. Your injuries are seriousI'm surprised you're even conscious right now.

Fiona's lips curl into a weak smirkhalf-defiant, half-bitter.

FIONA (V. O.)

152

They think they can break me I just need more time

Her fingers twitch toward the concealed syringe hidden by the sheets beside her waista last desperate move for control.

But before she can act

DEREK TAKAHASHI storms into the room from behind Troyeyes wild and furious at first glancebut then they freeze upon seeing

Fiona lying vulnerable on the bed...

HIS BREATH CATCHES

Without hesitationhe launches forward

And everything goes dark again.

FADE OUT

END EPISODE 50

EPISODE 51

INT. UNDERGROUND SUBWAY TUNNEL NIGHT

Cold ambient light flickers along the damp walls as Fiona Bennett, barely upright, grips a metal pipe for support. Her

breathing is ragged but her eyes burn with focus.

Derek Takahashi stands closemuscles trembling with tension, jaw set. Troy Navarro blocks the tunnel ahead, weapon

ready but lowered.

FIONA BENNETT

(VOICE LOW, CONTROLLED)

153

We don't have time to fight each other. If we stall here Sector Fourteen is lost.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

YOU'RE HURT

FIONA BENNETT

(INTERRUPTS)

I'm not your patient.

She pushes past himher stride unsteady but determined.

TROY NAVARRO

Stay back! You're in no condition

Fiona halts inches from Troy, chin lifted defiantly.

FIONA BENNETT

You think I care? Someone has to act while you two posture and threaten protocols.

Awkward silencethe hum of distant machinery overhead punctuates the standoff.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

(TIGHTLY)

Let her speak, Troy. She's the only one who understands what we're really up against now.

Troy's glare softens just enougha flicker of doubt visible beneath his steel exterior.

INT. SUBWAY TUNNEL FORMER MAINTENANCE HUB MOMENTS LATER

154

The trio crouch beside a battered utility cabinet; Fiona unfurls a crumpled schematic across an overturned crate lit

by Derek's flashlight beam.

FIONA BENNETT

(QUIET INTENSITY)

The main junction lies herebeneath Sector Fourteen's core research vaults. That's where Paloma rerouted containment powerand

probably where she hides evidence tying us all together

She circles locations with trembling fingerseach mark calculated precision despite exhaustion.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

If those things breach this line

FIONA BENNETT

Then everything above collapses into chaos... and there will be no more witnesses left alive or sane to tell

anyone what happened down here.

Sudden clatter echoes from deeper tunnelsa metallic scraping sound that sets nerves on edge.

EXT. ABANDONED ROOFTOP GARDEN NIGHT (FLASH BACK INTERCUTS)

Rapid flashes: Fiona on her knees among broken planters and weeds under moonlight; Troy framed by swirling city lights beyond

rusted fencing; Derek clutching a bloodied sample kit near wind-battered vinesall desperate yet determined in their own way.

155

BACK TO:

INT. SUBWAY TUNNEL CONTINUOUS

Shadows move at the far end of the passagewaythe threat advancing unseen but palpable as tension thickens between them again.

FIONA BENNETT

To both men:

Enough hiding behind rulesor guilt trips about my healthI choose how far I go tonight.
She rises unsteadilybut faces forward into darkness with resolve kindling anew.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

(RESPECTFULNOT PLEADING)
Then let me go first.
If they take someoneit won't be you this time.

He steps forward protectivelybut Fiona stops him with one hand pressed gently against his chest.
Their eyes meeta flash of understanding fraught with fearand something sharper than friendship fighting its way through trauma and transformation.

SUDDENLY

From behind them: A security alert pulses faintly from deep within Derek's jacket pocketa silent call code known only by inner-circle lab staff.
They freezeall three recognizing it instantly.

TROY NAVARRO

156

That signal means Paloma knows we're moving underground.
We're out of time.

Beat.

All eyes lock on Fiona.

Her voice cuts through hesitation:

FIONA BENNETT

(DECISIVE)

Follow my lead or get out of my way.

END EPISODE 51

EPISODE 52

EXT. ABANDONED ROOFTOP GARDEN NIGHT

Moonlit city sprawls belowjagged skyline, cold wind carving through wild overgrown planters and shattered benches.

Fiona Bennett shoves open the warped door, emerging first into the garden's tangled dark.

Derek Takahashi follows, watchful. Troy Navarro stalks lastscanning every shadow with military precision.

Fiona traces a broken railing, face set in iron resolve.

TROY NAVARRO

This isn't secure.
We need covernot an open sky.

FIONA BENNETT

We need perspective.

157

Up herewe see them coming.
Or leaving.

She gestures to the city lightsa map of shifting danger zones below.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

(LOW)
Signal'll draw Paloma's hit team fast. You really want to make our stand up here?

Fiona kneels by a half-buried junction box wedged among roots and rusted metal pipes. She pries it open with trembling hands but

steady focussplicing wires together expertly as Derek moves closer, wary but impressed.

FIONA BENNETT

No one expects us above ground now. Not even her.
BesidesI'm not making a stand.
I'm pulling control back where it belongs: ours.

INT. CORPORATE SKYSCRAPER LOBBY NIGHT

Polished marble floor gleams beneath harsh overhead lights; security cameras sweep silently as two figures in black suits

(Grant Langston and Paloma Stroud) stride toward a bank of elevators.

Paloma checks her wrist displaya pulsing red dot tracks movement high above street level.

PALOMA STROUD

They're improvising again.

158

Navarro's lost his edgehe wouldn't take this risk unless he was desperate or following someone else's lead.

EXT. ABANDONED ROOFTOP GARDEN NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Wind howls louder now; Fiona finishes re-routing the device inside the old junction boxhands shaking from exhaustion

but eyes fierce with intent.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

(SOFTLY)
You sure you're ready for this?

She doesn't look at himbut her voice slices through Derek's worry and Troy's silent judgment alike:

FIONA BENNETT

The only thing I've ever been sure of is what happens if we let monsters call all the shotsin here or out there.
Not tonight.

Sudden squawkthe jury-rigged comm crackles to life:
Distorted voices filter through: "Unit Alpha converging rooftop garden perimeter sector lockdown authorized..."

Troy tenses beside her; Derek's fists clench involuntarilya tremor rippling up his arm that he barely suppresses.

TROY NAVARRO

(DEFENSIVE, LOW)
If this goes wrongthey'll blame me for letting you run point on this op.

FIONA BENNETT

159

Then don't let it go wrong.

INT. CORPORATE SKYSCRAPER ELEVATOR ASCENDING NIGHT

Paloma stands rigid beside Grant Langston as numbers climb past forty floorsall business until she flashes a private smile his way:

PALOMA STROUD

Be ready for anything when those doors open.

EXT. ABANDONED ROOFTOP GARDEN NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Footsteps echo up stairwell metal behind themthe enemy closing fast from inside while drones blink red across adjacent rooftops outside.

Derek steps protectively between Fiona and approaching dangerbut she pushes past him toward the ledge instead:
Exposed against neon-lit night sky

She lifts her chinand speaks quiet but defiant:

FIONA BENNETT

(TO BOTH MEN)
Whatever comes next
You follow my ordersor get left behind.

Behind them: The rooftop access door creaks

SHADOWS SPILL FORWARD
Silhouettes in tactical gear fan out under moonlight,
weapons leveled,
eyes seeking their quarry

And Fiona stands tall at the broken edge, wind whipping hair across determined eyes

UNAFRAID
for once
of being seen leading.
CUT TO
BLACK
END EPISODE 52

EPISODE 53

INT. HIGH-SECURITY CORPORATE SKYSCRAPER LOBBY NIGHT

Fiona's heels strike the polished marble as she strides through the shadowed lobby, flanked by Derek and a guarded Troy.

The elevator doors open with a soft chime.

She steps inside without hesitation.

TROY
(urgently)
Wait!

But Fiona doesn't turn back. She presses the button for Sector Fourteen's core floora secret level few even know exists.

The doors close smoothly behind them, cutting off any chance of retreat or interference.

DEREK
(low, tense)
Sector Fourteen That's where everything started to spiral out of control. What are you planning?

FIONA
(calm, resolute)

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I'm going to finish thison my terms. The lab may be broken beyond repair now, but I won't let it fall into their handsnot after everything we've lost.

Troy exhales sharply at her tone before forcing himself steady against his growing obsession and desperation.

TROY (V. O.)
She thinks I'll just follow her lead? This isn't over yet not until that sector belongs to meand her heart does too

He watches Fiona closely in the dim reflection on the elevator wall,

his eyes darkening with possessive hunger,

unwilling to accept losing either territory or control over her.

CUT TO

BLACK

END EPISODE 53

EPISODE 54

INT. SECTOR FOURTEEN CORE ELEVATOR DESCENDING NIGHT

Fluorescent lights flicker overhead. The walls hum with power.

Fiona Bennett stands rigid, her eyes locked on the elevator panel as red numbers tick downward.

Derek Takahashi shifts uneasily at her side, stealing glances between Fiona and Troy Navarrowho watches both with a predator's intensity.

TROY NAVARRO

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(voice low, forceful)
You're walking into a hornet's nest. Sector Fourteen isn't just data and old samples anymore.

FIONA BENNETT
I'm aware of exactly what's waiting down there.
(pauses, then cuts him a look)
But you still haven't told me who else knows about this floor. Or why you hid access codes from me for weeks.

Troy's jaw tightenshe says nothing, gaze fixed ahead.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(softly)
We have to work together now. If any of us tries to play hero alone we lose everything that matters.

The elevator shudders as it slows

Doors whirr open with an echoing clang.

INT. SECTOR FOURTEEN CORE CONTROL ANTECHAMBER NIGHT

Cold vapor spills across cracked tiles; consoles blink erratically amid strewn debris and shattered glass cylinders

lining the far wall.

Fiona steps out firstshoulders squared in spite of exhaustionfollowed by Derek and finally Troy, who lingers warily behind

them both.

She scans the chaos:
A sprawling command table has been overturned; faded maps show creature migration zones radiating from the lab

163

like infection veins.
On one wall: A massive containment door marked "PRIMARY NODE".

FIONA BENNETT
This is where they accelerated mutation cycles.
Where Paloma started breeding packs she couldn't control
(stops abruptly at a bloodstain near her boot)

Derek follows her gazea tremor crossing his face as he spots claw marks gouged deep into steel nearby.
He reaches lightly for Fiona's arm but stops himself before touching her.

DEREK TAKAHASHI
If anything survived containment failure...
It could be intelligent enough not to attack right away.
We'll need every edge we can geteven him.
(glancing at Troy)

TROY NAVARRO
(grim smile)
There are things on this level I never wanted either of you to seeand enemies watching we haven't met yet.
But if protecting Sector Fourteen means locking horns with your monstersor mineI won't back down now.

Suddenly: static crackles through overhead speakersa voice distorts in layers:

PALOMA STROUD (V. O.)
(intermittent broadcast)
Sector breach detected primary node unresponsive system override required

164

Lights pulse red along the bulkheada countdown begins above PRIMARY NODE: "FAILSAFE PROTOCOL ENGAGED / 10:00".

Fiona turns sharply on Troy:

FIONA BENNETT
How much time do we really have? What did you set up here?

Troy holds her stare, sweat starting beneath his collar despite his icy facade:

TROY NAVARRO
Failsafe triggers total lockdownincluding incineration protocol if external overrides fail within ten minutes.
Paloma planned it months agoin case my own team turned against HQ or something worse got loose down here

He edges closernot threatening but desperate:

If you want everyone above ground safeyou'll need my biometrics in tandem with yours at node control.

INT. SECTOR FOURTEEN PRIMARY NODE CONTROL ROOM NIGHT

Warning klaxons throb softly around torn cabling and scorched panels inside Primary Node Controlthe epicenter of containment

tech gone wrong.

The trio enters together; screens display mutating DNA strands overlaying camera feedscreatures roaming sealed corridors

beyond reinforced glass windows toward their location

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Derek stares, haunted by glimpses of familiar faces warped among monstrous forms onscreen
His hand clutches a serum injector at his belt unconsciously

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(low anguish)
Some are survivors... they didn't all diethey changed because no one stopped Paloma soon enough...

Silence hangs thick until Fiona crosses straight to the central console,
fingers flying over cryptic controls as warning messages flash past:

"BIOMETRIC AUTHORIZATION REQUIRED // DUAL KEYS ONLY"

She lifts troubled eyes toward Derek firstbut then fixes fiercely on Troy beside her:

FIONA BENNETT
No more secrets or deals behind closed doorsnot between us threewe end this together or not at all!

Her trembling hand hovers over hers side-by-side with Troy's,

WAITING FOR MUTUAL ASSENT

For an instant everything freezes:
Red light paints harsh shadows across each face;
Outside the window something hulking paces watchful,
waiting for whichever human dares act first...

CUT TO
BLACK
END EPISODE 54

EPISODE 55

166

INT. SECTOR FOURTEEN CORE CONTROL ROOM NIGHT

Fiona Bennett's hand hovers, knuckles white beside Troy Navarro's on the biometric pad.

Derek Takahashi stands a step back, watching the red-lit glasshis reflection flickers among prowling monstrous shadows beyond.

A guttural howl echoes from outside. The floor vibrates.

TROY NAVARRO
(low, urgent)
On three. No hesitation.

FIONA BENNETT
(steady)
We do this togetherI mean it.

He nods once, jaw tight. They drop their hands onto the sensors in sync

The console flashes: "AUTHORIZATION ACCEPTED // OVERRIDE ENABLED"

Alarms pulse softlydoors begin to seal across camera feeds as containment protocols cascadebut Fiona interjects commands at lightning speed:

FIONA BENNETT
Don't lock us out of main controlwe need manual access if anything fails.

She glances over her shoulder at Derek

FIONA BENNETT (CONT'D)
Derek! You said you can reprogram their tracking? Now or never.

DEREK TAKAHASHI

167

I'll try but I don't know what happens if my override fails with them so close

His voice trembles; eyes flick briefly gold before returning to normal as he plugs into a secondary terminal and begins tapping furiously.

EXT. SECTOR FOURTEEN REINFORCED GLASS OBSERVATION HALLWAY NIGHT

Monstrous shapes press huge claws against glassone cocks its head, fixating on Fiona inside as she moves between screens and panels with cold precision.

INT. SECTOR FOURTEEN CORE CONTROL ROOM

Behind Fiona and Troy, Derek curses under his breaththe serum injector ready but unused by his hip.

Camila Kane's voice crackles over comms:

CAMILA KANE (V. O.)
(urgent whisper)
Perimeter is holdingfor now! Two more creatures moving toward your position!

Troy stiffens; his gaze snaps to Fiona as she reroutes power grids on-screen:

TROY NAVARRO
Bennettyou're not authorized for those overrides! If you push too far we all die here!

Fiona doesn't flinch under his glare.

FIONA BENNETT
You want to survive? Then trust meor get out of my way.

168

He hesitatesa flash of doubt breaking through stone-cold resolve
but then steps closer instead of backing down.

Their shoulders nearly brush; tension thrums electric between them.

She lowers her tone just for him:

FIONA BENNETT (CONT'D)
(contained fury)
No more posturing, Troynot now. Either help me end this or admit you'd rather watch us burn than let someone else lead!

For a split secondit looks like he'll lash outbut instead,
his fingers fly across auxiliary controls beside hers:

TROY NAVARRO
(snarled whisper)
Fineshow me how you plan to win with monsters at the door.

EXT. ROOFTOP GARDEN - CORPORATE SKYSCRAPER - LATER THAT NIGHT

Wind rushes wild through high tangled grassmoonlight silver on shattered tiles and riotous overgrown plants reclaiming

concrete rooftop spaces above Sector Fourteen proper.

From an armored hatch emerges Fiona first face wind-burned but determined,
holding a battered comm receiver aloft while scanning for signals amid city lights below;
after her come Derek pale sweat running down his temple and finally Troy,

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gun drawn but arms trembling minutely from adrenaline crash not fear alone.

They fan out instinctively into cover behind rusted planters,
breathing hard in bracing night air:

DEREK TAKAHASHI
(hushed awe)
It workedwe bought timebut they're adapting already I felt it when they tried to break code inside me

He stares at his own shaking hands;
faint golden veins pulse beneath skin before fading away again
he hides them quickly when he sees Fiona looking worriedly over.

She kneels near him; compassion barely masked beneath professional urgency:

FIONA BENNETT
Did any part of that override hurt you?

DEREK TAKAHASHI
Not physically... But something recognized me in thereas kin or preyI can't tell anymore...

Silence falls heavy until Troy interrupts,

TROY NAVARRO
(on edge)
We stay exposed up here much longerthey'll circle back eventually unless we find leverage fast. What are your next orders?

For once there's no challenge in itthe words genuine even if rough-edged;
he waits on her call with eyes sharper than before

She rises fully,

170

the city sprawling broken-yet-beautiful behind her silhouette:

FIONA BENNETT
(calm authority)
We lure them somewhere we controla trap only one side survives. But I choose who walks away this timenot Paloma, not corporate brassand definitely not these things hunting us like cattle!

All three regard each othertheir alliance fragile yet realas wind wails higher overhead,

and suddenly Camila's panicked voice cuts through static again:

CAMILA KANE (V. O.)
(distorted/fearful)
Sector Fourteen breach detected! Multiple signatures converging upstairsthey've found another way up after all

Close on:

The rooftop exit shudders violently from below
massive claws scrape metal just inches from where their feet brace against fractured tile

CUT TO

BLACK
END EPISODE 55

EPISODE 56

INT. SECTOR FOURTEEN CORE CONTROL ROOM NIGHT

The rooftop exit trembles under the assaultmetal groans, shards of tile scatter with every scrape.

171

Fiona spins around in time to see a massive claw slam into the steel door frame just inches from where she stands.

Her breath catches; her eyes narrow sharply as adrenaline surges.

FIONA
(voice cold, razor-sharp)
Hold this position. No one moves.

Troy steps closer, his voice steady but tense as he positions himself protectively beside her.

TROY
(grim)
Camila's breach alert was no accident. They're pushing coordinated strikes nowwe can't stay exposed any longer!

Derek stiffens behind them, scanning the darkened perimeter for threatsa flicker of doubt crosses his face before he masks it with professionalism.

DE
(quietly urgent)
We need to shut down all external access points immediately or they'll overwhelm us here too

Before he finishes, another massive impact rocks the rooftop exitthe force nearly topples Fiona and Troy off balance.

Fiona instinctively throws out an arm to steady Troy; their eyes lock for a split secondher command unwavering despite exhaustion, his trust absolute yet tinged with growing desperation.

Suddenly,

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CAMILA'S VOICE bursts through static once again:

CAMILA KANE (V. O.)
(panicked)

Multiple signatures converging upstairsthey've found another way up after all

The words cut sharp across the night air before fading abruptly into silence

Fiona's gaze hardens instantlyshe doesn't hesitate. Her hand slams onto the biometric console next to her left hip;

fingers press firmly against its surface in swift succession .

She turns on her heel without breaking stride toward Derek and Troy , urgency radiating from every movement .

FIONA
(firm resolve )
Lockdown initiated . Seal every entry point including this one ! We regroup inside . Now !

Troy snaps into action beside her ; both move swiftly toward control panel at center wall , their footsteps echoing

sharply through empty space .

Derek follows moments later , already tapping commands into handheld device syncing wirelessly with central systems .

The three form a tight triangle moving forward ; tension crackling visibly between them like charged electricity

ready to ignite at any moment

173

INT./EXT SECTOR FOURTEEN ROOFTOP EXIT/CORE CONTROL ROOM

As Fiona reaches core control room doors leading outside huge claw swings violently back forth against metal gate entrance few meters away

She glances over shoulder briefly then nods decisively at Derek while gripping Troy 's shoulder firmly .

Without hesitation :

They cross threshold together - sliding heavy steel door closed behind them / locking electronically within seconds ,

CUT TO

BLACK

END EPISODE 56

EPISODE 57

INT. SECTOR FOURTEEN CORE CONTROL ROOM NIGHT

The doors seal shut with a final, heavy thudmetal against metal.

Fiona leans back against the wall, breathing hard. Her eyes flick to both men.

FIONA (CONT'D)
We're safefor now. But this isn't over.

Troy's gaze shifts to the rooftop exit beyond the glassclaw strikes still echoing in his mind.

TROY
They won't stop until they break through that gate and once inside, there's no telling what they'll do next.

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Derek steps forward, voice steady but tense as he taps into his device synced with central systems.

DEREK
I'm pushing emergency override codes nowto reinforce every lock within Sector Fourteen. It'll take time... but it should hold them out for at least an hour if nothing else goes wrong.

Troy exhales sharply, running a hand through his hair before turning fully toward Fionawith something new in his expression: urgency laced with quiet desperation.

TROY
You've been hiding something from me all alongabout your connection to Sector Fourteen and its secrets

Fiona meets Troy's gaze without flinching; her tone is calm but unyielding when she finally speaks:

FIONA
That chapter of my past has long been closedand I intend to keep it that way for good reason. Right now, our priority is survivalnot digging up old wounds or secrets better left buried...

BEFORE SHE CAN FINISH

An alarm blares throughout the roomthe screens flicker red as warnings flash across every monitor in sync: "LOCKDOWN INITIATED." "SECTOR PERIMETER BREACH IMMINENT."

Everyone freezes instantly; tension snaps tight like a drawn bowstring

175

Suddenlya deafening crash reverberates from outside. The core control room shakes violently under impact forcewaves pounding relentlessly against sealed walls

The lights shudder then cut out completelythe entire chamber plunges into utter darkness

Silence follows seconds latera suffocating void filled only by distant, monstrous growls creeping ever closer

CUT TO

BLACK

END EPISODE 57

EPISODE 58

INT. SECTOR FOURTEEN CORE CONTROL ROOM NIGHT

The room remains pitch black as the distant growls draw nearer, shadows flickering against the walls from erratic emergency lights.

Fiona's breath hitches, her senses sharpening in the darkness.

FIONA
(grim)
They're inside. This lockdown was never meant to hold them out for long...

Troy rushes to a side panel and slams it open, his fingers fumbling over exposed wiring.

TROY
(panicked)
I'm rerouting power manually it'll take seconds but

176

Before he can finish, a massive impact rocks the control room. The wall beside them buckles inward with a deafening crash.

Derek instinctively shoves Fiona aside just as jagged metal shards explode through the openingsending debris scattering across the floor.

An enormous clawed hand reaches into the breach before withdrawing slowly, dripping dark ichor onto the shattered tiles like blood rain.

The trio freezes in horror at its grotesque outlinea monstrous hybrid form glistening under faint red emergency light: twisted limbs of flesh and steel eyes burning with primal rage

Suddenlya low guttural snarl reverberates from deep within their cheststhe alpha beast emerges fully through broken steel frame of Sector Fourteen core control room entrance!

Its hulking silhouette towers over them; razor-sharp claws scrape along fractured concrete walls; each step sends tremors through dust-covered vents

Alpha Beast (Voiceover): Territory breached invaders detected

The creature steps forward deliberatelyits gaze locking coldly on Fiona first, then sweeping past her to fixate on Troy with chilling intensity that freezes him solid in place.

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Alpha Beast (Voiceover): Target identified... rightful heir must submit or be eliminated...

Without warningit lunges toward Troy with brutal force!

Troy barely reacts before crushing jaws slam shut around his throatdragging him backward into shadowy wreckage beyond

sight amid roaring echoes of tearing flesh and snapped bone

Derek lets out a strangled scream

He dashes after them blindlybut before he can reach furt her inside,

A second earthshaking blow strikes behind him

HE SPINS VIOLENTLY

Only to collide headlong into another monstrous figure emerging from fractured wall behind him:

It's Palomaher body now fused grotesquely between human shape and metallic insect shellwith one arm clutching Derek tightly

while her other mechanical appendages close fast around his neck

Paloma leans low toward Derek's ear;

Her voice is thick with venomous satisfaction:

PALOMA (V. O.)
(soft hiss)
You thought you could hide forever?

178

Before Derek can reacttheir lips collide violently in an unnatural kissand all air escapes from his lungs
Darkness swallows everything again.

CUT TO

BLACK

END EPISODE 58

EPISODE 59

INT. SECTOR FOURTEEN CORE CONTROL ROOM NIGHT

The room remains pitch black as the distant growls draw nearer, shadows flickering against the walls from erratic movement.

Suddenly, a heavy metallic sound echoesfootsteps resound like thunder across the steel floor.

FIONA (V. O.)
(tense)
They're almost here

The door trembles with each impact before finally giving waya massive clawed hand slams into the frame and rips it open in one brutal motion.

From the shattered entrance emerges PALOMA, her monstrous form illuminated by moonlight spilling inside. She steps forward smoothly, arms outstretched to reveal Derek trapped within her grotesque embrace.

PALOMA (V. O.)
(soft hiss)
You thought you could hide forever?

179

Before Derek can reacttheir lips collide violently in an unnatural kissand all air escapes from his lungs

Darkness swallows everything again.

CUT TO

BLACK

END EPISODE 59

EPISODE 60

INT. SECTOR FOURTEEN CORE CONTROL ROOM NIGHT

The room remains pitch black as the distant growls draw nearer, shadows flickering against the walls from erratic movement.

Suddenly, a heavy metallic sound echoesfootsteps resound like thunder across the steel floor.

FIONA (V. O.)
(tense)
They're almost here

The door trembles with each impact before finally giving waya massive clawed hand slams into the frame and rips it open in one brutal motion.

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(soft hiss)
You thought you could hide forever?

180

Before Derek can reacttheir lips collide violently in an unnatural kissand all air escapes from his lungs

Darkness swallows everything again.

CUT TO

BLACK

INT. SECTOR FOURTEEN CORE CONTROL ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Light floods back into the room as Fiona's eyes snap open. She presses her palms against her temples, breathing heavilyher

gaze darting around frantically until she spots Derek lying unconscious on a nearby console.

FIONA

(surprised)

Derek? You're awake!

She rushes over and shakes him gently but firmly.

DEREK

(grimacing)

Feels like I've been through hell Paloma... she

Suddenly, his eyes widen in shock when he recognizes Fiona standing there beside him. His breath catches for just a moment

too long

Derek's body stiffens, but instead of lashing out, he blinks, struggling to regain control.

DEREK

(softly)

Fiona I'm sorry. I didn't want to hurt you.

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Fiona's tense expression softens as she reaches out, placing a steady hand on his arm.

FIONA
(quietly)
We're safe now. We'll get through thistogether.

Derek nods weakly, the feral edge fading from his eyes.

They share a long lookhopeful, relieved.

The distant sounds of the facility's alarms fade, replaced by calm.

FIONA
(whispering)
Let's find a way out of here. A real one.

DEREK
(agreeing)
Together.

They rise slowly, supporting each other as the room brightens with the first light of dawn filtering through the windows.

FADE OUT

.

END EPISODE 60